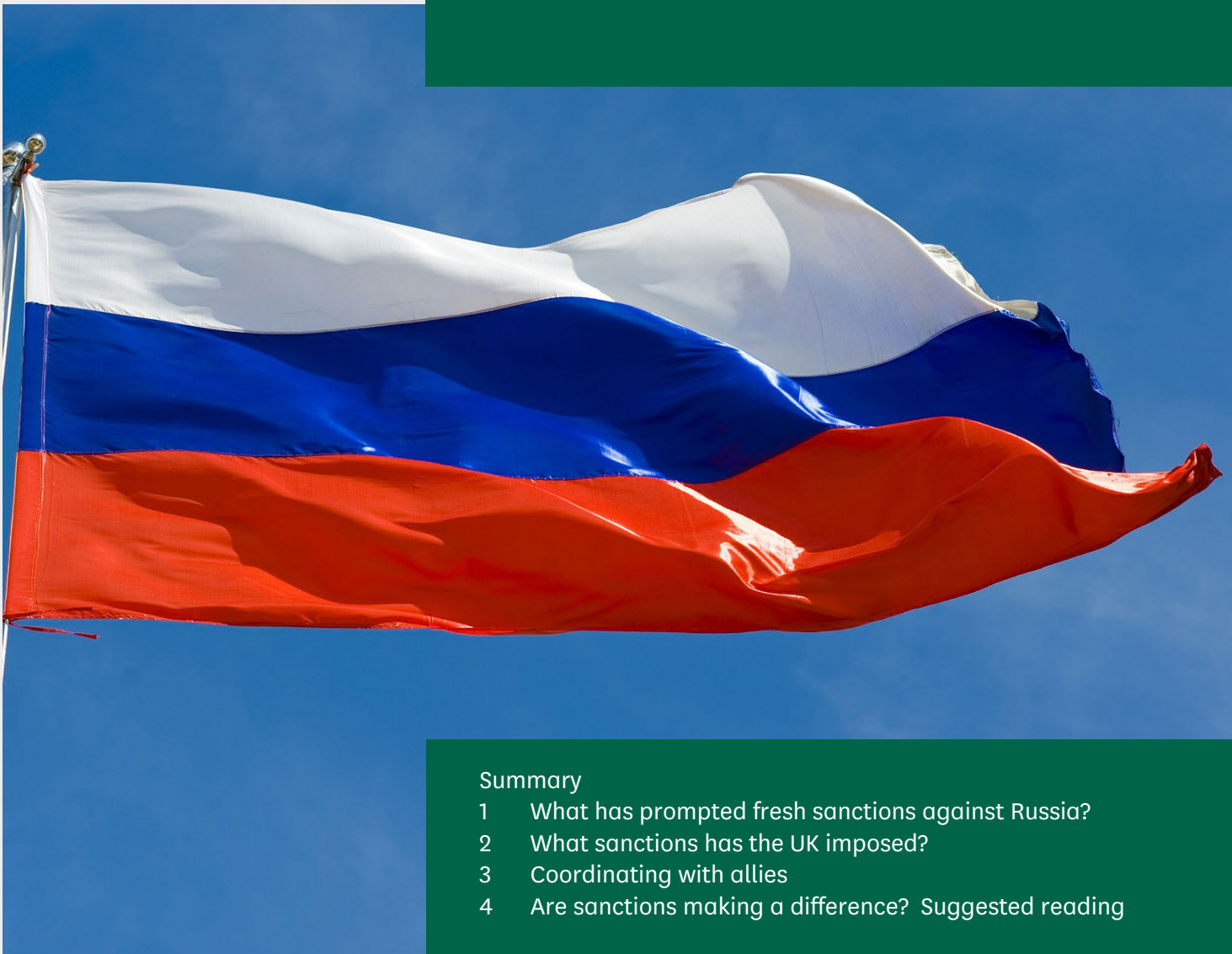


Research Briefing

By Claire Mills

21 January 2025

Sanctions against Russia (February 2022 to January 2025)



Summary

- 1 What has prompted fresh sanctions against Russia?
- 2 What sanctions has the UK imposed?
- 3 Coordinating with allies
- 4 Are sanctions making a difference? Suggested reading

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Summary

Coordinated sanctions against Russia have been in place since 2014 under various UK sanctions regimes.

The country-specific Russia regime was imposed in a coordinated move by the EU, US, UK and other allies such as Canada in reaction to the annexation of Crimea in 2014 and the ongoing destabilisation of Ukraine.

The UK has also sanctioned Russian nationals and entities under other regimes, primarily in response to human rights abuses in Russia, anti-corruption, cyber and chemical weapon attacks. These sanctions are outlined in Library research briefing, [Russian sanctions prior to the invasion of Ukraine](#).

UK [sanctions imposed in relation to the death of Russian opposition figure Alexei Navalny](#) in February 2024, have been put in place under the UK's Global Human Rights sanctions regime.

Albeit related to the conflict in Ukraine, sanctions imposed by the UK in October 2024 in response to [the use of chemical weapons on the battlefield in Ukraine](#), have also been imposed under the UK's [chemical weapons sanctions regime](#).

It is the expansion of the country-specific Russia sanctions regime since February 2022 that is the focus of this briefing.

Response to the 2022 invasion of Ukraine

In the build-up to the current conflict in Ukraine, Western allies warned Russia that any breach of Ukraine's territorial integrity and sovereignty would be met with unprecedented economic measures. Following [Russia's recognition of independence of the self-proclaimed Luhansk People's Republic and the Donetsk People's Republic](#), and the deployment of Russian troops under the guise of peacekeeping operations, initial sanctions were introduced by the West.

On 24 February 2022, Russian military forces crossed the border into Ukraine and continue to conduct a full-scale assault on the country. The EU, UK, US, and other allies, have responded with significant coordinated sanctions, targeting Russia's financial sector, aviation and shipping, strategic sectors of the economy such as defence, aerospace and energy, individuals close to the Putin regime and those facilitating Russia's invasion of Ukraine, including [actors in third countries](#).

Sanctions are being introduced on a rolling basis and the UK Government has consistently said that “[nothing is off the table](#)”. Sanctions continue to target key sources of Russian revenue, while efforts have also become increasingly focused on the prevention of sanctions evasion and the role of third-party enablers internationally.

As of 15 January 2025:

- [1,733 individuals and 382 entities are subject to UK sanctions under the Russia regime](#) (PDF).
- [Almost 2,400 individuals and entities are subject to EU sanctions](#) in response to Russian military aggression against Ukraine.

In tandem with trade and financial restrictions, [Russia is now the most sanctioned country in the world](#). Questions remain however, over the effectiveness of those sanctions as Russia has sought alternative markets, trade routes and methods for circumventing Western sanctions, including the use of a ‘shadow fleet’ of tankers, ageing vessels with obscure ownership which are uninsured and often environmentally unsound, to transport sanctioned Russian crude oil.

This briefing provides an overview of the sanctions that have been imposed on Russia since February 2022 by the UK, EU, US and other major allies and partners.

Recent [EU](#) and [G7 proposals](#) to use the profits from sanctioned Russian assets to fund military support and reconstruction in Ukraine is examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions, international law and seizing Russian assets](#).

1

What has prompted fresh sanctions against Russia?

On 24 February 2022 Russia launched military action in Ukraine, with forces crossing into the country from Belarus in the north, Russia in the east and Crimea in the south. The move came after months of diplomacy aimed at averting a crisis and despite Russian insistence that it had no plans to invade Ukraine.

- Detail of the build up to the conflict, diplomatic efforts to avert the crisis and a brief overview of the conflict so far is available in Library briefings: [Ukraine: Russia's 'red line'](#) and [Ukraine conflict: An overview](#)

Since the annexation of Crimea in 2014, Western nations, including the US, the UK and EU Member States, have made clear their support for Ukraine's territorial integrity and sovereignty and its right to choose its security partnerships.

At the outset of the current crisis, the West warned Russia that any military escalation would have significant economic consequences, including an unprecedented package of sanctions targeting Russia's financial institutions, energy sector, and individuals close to the Kremlin. Halting Russia's controversial [Nord Stream 2 gas pipeline to Europe](#) was also considered as part of any sanctions package.

1 What is the purpose of sanctions?

Sanctions are considered a useful foreign policy tool. They are restrictive measures, intended to be temporary, that can be used to force a change in behaviour, constrain a country's actions or to communicate a political message to other countries and individuals.

While the UK can impose its own sanctions, coordination is often sought with allies, particularly the EU and [the US](#), to achieve maximum effect. Under international law, the UK is also obliged to implement United Nations sanctions when they are imposed.

The UK has 38 [thematic and country-specific sanctions regimes](#) in place under the [Sanctions and Anti-Money Laundering Act 2018](#), of which the country-specific Russia regime is one of them.

On 22 February 2024 the Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office published the [UK's first ever Sanctions Strategy](#). It sets out the government's approach to using sanctions as a tool of foreign and security policy.

1.1

Scope of the UK's Russia sanctions regime

The Russia sanctions regime is specifically aimed at:

encouraging Russia to cease actions destabilising Ukraine or undermining or threatening the territorial integrity, sovereignty or independence of Ukraine.¹

It does not allow for sanctions designations in relation to other issues, such as human rights abuses in Russia. Those sanctions can be implemented by the UK under one of its [thematic sanctions regimes](#) such as the Global Human Rights regime (more commonly referred to as Magnitsky sanctions).

In June 2023 the government also introduced legislation enabling sanctions to be maintained against Russia until it pays compensation to Ukraine. The [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2023](#), which came into force on 20 June 2023, amend the [original 2019 regulations establishing the UK's Russia sanctions regime](#), and expand the purpose for which sanctions can be imposed.

The purpose of sanctions against Russia are now to:

1. Encourage Russia to cease actions destabilising Ukraine or undermining or threatening the territorial integrity, sovereignty or independence of Ukraine.
2. Promote the payment of compensation by Russia for damage, loss or injury suffered by Ukraine on or after 24 February 2022 and as a result of Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

This change reflected the government's view that "Russia bears full responsibility for the war and the damage it has caused, including to Ukraine's critical infrastructure".²

¹ [Explanatory Memorandum to the Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2023 \(PDF\)](#), June 2023

² [Explanatory Memorandum to the Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2023 \(PDF\)](#), June 2023

2

What sanctions has the UK imposed?

2 Headlines

- As of 15 January 2025 [1,733 individuals and 382 entities are subject to UK sanctions under the Russia regime](#) (PDF). [1,900 of those designations](#) (PDF) have been made since February 2022.
- [29 Russian banks \(accounting for over 90% of the Russian banking sector\) and 131 oligarchs and their family members with a combined net worth of over £147 billion, have been sanctioned by the UK.](#)
- [Over £20 billion of UK-Russia bilateral trade is under full or partial sanction.](#)
- [£22.7 billion of Russian assets in the UK have been frozen.](#)

In opposition, the Labour Party were supportive of sanctions imposed against Russia, although frequently questioned [the strength and effectiveness of sanctions enforcement](#) and [the speed of UK efforts on moving toward seizing sanctioned Russian assets](#). On 24 July 2024, Prime Minister Keir Starmer said “[the use now made of what has been seized and frozen is an important issue on which I think we can move forward](#)”, indicating that the government had begun discussions “about how we can take more effective measures”.

Proposals, and the legal debate around the use of sanctioned Russian assets to assist Ukraine, are examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions, international law and seizing Russian assets](#).

Useful sources

- The latest UK sanctions notices related to Russia, and the current list of designated persons are available at: [Financial sanctions, Russia - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#).
- Sanctions announcements are collated at: [UK sanctions following Russia's invasion of Ukraine - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)
- The UK sanctions list, which covers all sanctions regimes implemented in the UK, can be searched at: [The UK Sanctions List](#)

“Together with our international partners, we have unleashed the largest, most severe package of sanctions ever imposed on a major economy”.

[Lord Ahmad of Wimbledon](#), 25 April 2024

On 31 January 2022, the then Foreign Secretary confirmed that the government would introduce legislation enabling “an unprecedented package of coordinated sanctions”, should Russia invade Ukraine.³

The [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2022](#) were published on 10 February 2022. The regulations amended the designation criteria initially set out in the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) Regulations 2019](#), and identified sectors of “strategic significance” to the Russian Government, including the chemical, defence, energy, extractives, electronics, ICT and financial services sectors.

Under the new measures, the UK is now able to target the strategic interests of the Russian state more broadly, including Russian banks, the energy sector, and individuals with close ties to the Kremlin. Introducing the legislation, the Foreign Secretary said:

We will be able to target any company that is linked to the Russian state, engages in business of economic significance to the Russian state, or operates in a sector of strategic significance to the Russian state. Not only will we be able to target these entities, we will also be able to go after those who own or control them. This will be the toughest sanctions regime against Russia we have ever had, and it is the most radical departure in approach since leaving the European Union. Those in and around the Kremlin will have nowhere to hide.⁴

The government did not confirm who may be targeted, or with what measures, but said that it would “use these new powers to maximum effect if it pursues its aggressive intent towards Ukraine”, that sanctions would be applied “without fear or favour” and that “nothing is off the table”.⁵

Sanctions would also be coordinated with allies, including the EU and the US, to achieve maximum effect.

Russia was already subject to an arms embargo, which was imposed in 2014 in response to Russia’s annexation of Crimea.⁶

The application of sanctions to the UK’s Overseas Territories, is examined in House of Commons Library, [The UK’s Overseas Territories and sanctions against Russia](#).

2.1

Initial sanctions

The first wave of UK sanctions was announced on 22 February 2022, in response to Russia’s recognition of the Donetsk People’s Republic (DPR) and Luhansk People’s Republic (LPR) in eastern Ukraine as independent states.

³ HC Deb 31 January 2022, c55

⁴ HC Deb 31 January 2022, c56

⁵ HC Deb 31 January 2022, c56 and c58

⁶ This is examined in greater detail in Library briefing: [UK sanctions against Russia: Arms exports](#)

The Government described the deployment of Russian “peacekeeping” troops to the region, as “a renewed invasion” of Ukraine.⁷

Targeted sanctions were imposed on five Russian banks and three Russian oligarchs associated with the Kremlin: [Gennady Timchenko](#), [Boris Rotenberg](#) and [Igor Roteberg](#).⁸ All three individuals were already subject to US sanctions.⁹

The government also announced restrictions which would prevent Russia from issuing sovereign debt on UK markets,¹⁰ and would extend the territorial sanctions imposed on Crimea to non-government-controlled territory in Donetsk and Luhansk. The government also indicated its intention to sanction those members of the Russian Parliament who voted to recognise the independence of DPR and LPR on 15 February 2022.¹¹

386 members of the Russian Duma were subsequently sanctioned by the UK on 11 March 2022.¹² Members of Russia’s Federation Council were sanctioned on 15 March 2022.

[The Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.7\) Regulations 2022](#) extended the territorial sanctions, already applicable to Crimea, to the non-government-controlled areas in Donetsk and Luhansk.

Second tranche of sanctions

On 24 February 2022 the Government announced a second “comprehensive” and “unprecedented” set of sanctions, developed with international partners and allies, in response to the onset of Russian military action in Ukraine.¹³ Many of the measures set out in this second tranche were enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2022](#) and the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2022](#) which came into force on 1 March 2022.

The measures banned key Russian industries and companies from raising finance on the UK’s financial markets, stopped designated Russian banks from accessing Sterling and clearing payments through the UK and imposed an asset freeze on several major Russian financial institutions, including

⁷ HC Deb 22 February 2022, [Ukraine](#)

⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2022

⁹ “[Treasury Sanctions Russian Officials, Members Of The Russian Leadership’s Inner Circle, And An Entity For Involvement In The Situation In Ukraine](#)”, US Treasury, 20 March 2014; “[Treasury Designates Russian Oligarchs, Officials, and Entities in Response to Worldwide Malign Activity](#)”, US Treasury, 6 April 2018

¹⁰ Sovereign debt is the amount of money borrowed by a country, usually issued as bonds in a foreign currency. The debt is aimed at raising money to finance the country’s growth. Sovereign debt is examined in greater detail in Library research briefing, [Countering Russian influence in the UK](#)

¹¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2022. On 24 February the Government suggested 571 members of the Russian Duma and Federation Council would be targeted (FCDO, [Press release](#))

¹² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 11 March 2022

¹³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 February 2022

Russia's second largest bank VTB, preventing them from accessing the assets they hold in the UK. The government estimated that Russian banks cleared approximately £146 billion of Sterling payments into and out of the UK's financial system each year and that "around half of Russian trade is denominated in dollars or sterling".¹⁴

Trade restrictions were strengthened, with a ban on the export of critical dual-use technologies and components to Russia's electronics, telecommunications and aerospace sectors.

Asset freezes and travel bans were also imposed on numerous Russian oligarchs, including five members of Putin's inner circle. Under planned new banking restrictions, Russian nationals would be banned from having more than £50,000 in savings in UK banks accounts, although this measure was later dropped.¹⁵

Russia's flagship airline, Aeroflot, was also banned from UK airspace.

The government also confirmed that the subsidiaries of sanctioned entities are included in their list of designations and "across all sanctions regimes".¹⁶

Sanctions would also be issued against Belarus for its role in enabling Russian military action in Ukraine.¹⁷ These are examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions against countries supporting Russia's invasion of Ukraine](#).

2.2

A rolling programme of sanctions

The government has since committed to a "a rolling programme of intensifying sanctions", in coordination with allies in the EU and the G7.¹⁸ Further Russian financial institutions, strategic sectors of the Russian economy and major Russian state-owned companies have been targeted. More members of the Russian elite, and their families, have been made subject to asset freezes and travel bans.

¹⁴ HC Deb 1 March 2022, [Sanctions](#), c953

¹⁵ In May 2023 the Government confirmed that this measure would no longer be taken forward (Delegated Legislation Committee, [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2023](#), 15 May 2023, c3-4).

¹⁶ Foreign Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 3 March 2022

¹⁷ Approximately 30,000 Russian troops equipped with sophisticated military assets deployed to Belarus in early February 2022 under the guise of joint exercises. Those forces crossed the border from Belarus into Ukraine on 24 February 2022.

¹⁸ HC Deb 24 February 2022, c576

“UK, US and EU sanctions have deprived Russia of over \$400 billion in revenue since February 2022, equivalent to 4 more years of funding for the invasion”.

HM Government, [UK support to Ukraine: Factsheet](#), December 2024

On 2 March 2022 the then Prime Minister, Boris Johnson, committed to “publish a full list of all those associated with the Putin regime”, although he did not provide a timeframe for doing so.¹⁹ That list has not been made publicly available.

At the end of July 2022, the government expanded the criteria for those who could be subject to sanctions. Under the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.13\) regulations 2022](#) immediate family members of designated individuals and the management (as opposed to just senior management) of Russian state-controlled enterprises, or businesses benefitting from supporting the Russian Government can now also be designated.

The UK has also increasingly targeted third parties for their role in enabling sanctions evasion. The [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2024](#), introduced in May 2024, expand the basis upon which persons may be designated to include those providing financial services and making available funds, resources or technologies to any designated person or entity supporting, or benefitting from, the Russian Government. The regulations also expand the criteria for designating ships involved in the circumvention of sanctions (vessels that have been referred to as [Russia’s ‘shadow fleet’](#)). Those regulations were replaced in July 2024 by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2024](#). The regulations were re-introduced to meet the requirements for parliamentary scrutiny as set out by the Sanctions and Anti-Money Laundering Act 2018 and did not implement any new measures.²⁰

UK sanctions against third countries directly supporting Russia’s invasion of Ukraine are examined in Library research briefing: [Sanctions against countries supporting Russia’s invasion of Ukraine](#).

Proposals by the G7 and the EU to use the profits generated by sanctioned Russian assets to fund military support for, and reconstruction in, Ukraine are examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions, international law and seizing Russian assets](#).

3 Countering broader Russian influence in the UK

In response to [calls for broader measures to counter Russian influence in the UK](#), particularly in relation to Russian wealth in London, the Conservative government brought forward the [Economic Crime \(Transparency and Enforcement\) Bill](#) on 1 March 2022. The act was fast-tracked through Parliament and received Royal Assent on 14 March 2022. It introduces a

¹⁹ HC Deb 2 March 2022, c1033

²⁰ The No.2 regulations had not been approved by either the House of Commons or the House of Lords prior to Parliament being dissolved for the election on 30 May 2024.

beneficial ownership register of overseas entities owning UK property, reforms [Unexplained Wealth Orders](#) and makes changes to the designation and enforcement of sanctions.

Specifically, the act gives the government new powers to act in the public interest and designate individuals and entities under an urgent procedure, while evidence is gathered to sanction them under the UK's own standard procedures. This allows the UK to immediately designate individuals already sanctioned by the EU, the US and other allies.

The Government has also introduced the [Economic Crime and Corporate Transparency Act 2023](#), to tackle illicit finance and reduce economic crime, and the [National Security Act 2023](#), which overhauls existing legislation relating to threats from foreign states.

Designated individuals

So far, the UK has designated 1,733 individuals under the Russia sanctions regime (correct as of 15 January 2025).²¹

Putin, Lavrov and family members sanctioned

On 25 February 2022, the government sanctioned President Putin and Russian Foreign Minister, Sergey Lavrov, who are now subject to an asset freeze.²² Putin and Lavrov have also been sanctioned by the EU and US (see below). A travel ban was not imposed on them, as with other senior Russian officials, to allow for diplomatic meetings.

Sanctions against family members have been incrementally introduced, with the intention of sending “a strong signal that those benefiting from association of those responsible for Russian aggression are in scope of our sanctions”.²³ Targeted individuals include President Putin's daughters, his ex-wife, alleged partner Alina Kabaeva and her mother. Sergey Lavrov's wife, daughter and stepdaughter have also been designated.²⁴

Putin's inner circle sanctioned

Several figures from President Putin's inner circle have been designated, including Prime Minister Mikhail Mishustin, former Defence Minister Sergei Shoigu, former President of Russia, Dmitry Medvedev, who is Deputy

²¹ HM Treasury, [Consolidated list of financial sanctions targets in the UK, Regime: Russia \(PDF\)](#), 15 January 2025

²² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 25 February 2022

²³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022

²⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; [Press release](#), 8 April 2022; [Press release](#), 13 May 2022; [Press release](#), 24 February 2023

Chairman of the Russian Security Council and Patriarch Kirill, Head of the Russian Orthodox Church.²⁵

Russian military leaders

Several Russian military leaders, including General Valery Gerasimov, the Chief of the General Staff, were already sanctioned by the UK prior to the Russian invasion of Ukraine in February 2022.²⁶

Additional Deputy Defence Ministers, Russian military leaders and other military officials have since been designated for their role in the invasion, and in particular the commission of war crimes and intentional attacks against civilians and critical infrastructure.²⁷

Among the most prominent are Russian General Mikhail Mizintsev, nicknamed the “Butcher of Mariupol”, who is the Chief of the National Defence Command and Control Centre, which plans and directs all Russian military operations worldwide; Colonel General Andrey Serdyukov, Commander of Russian airborne forces; Major General Valery Flyustikov, Commander of Special Forces Operations and Colonel General Nikolay Bogdanovsky, First Deputy Chief of the General Staff.²⁸

On 25 June 2024, the International Criminal Court issued arrest warrants for General Gerasimov and Sergei Shoigu for the targeting of civilians and civilian infrastructure, which amount to war crimes under the Rome Statute.²⁹ The ICC has also issued arrest warrants for General Sergei Kobylash, a former Commander of Russia’s long-range aviation division of the aerospace force, and Admiral Viktor Sokolov, former Commander of the Russian Black Sea Fleet.³⁰ At the time of writing, neither are on the [UK’s Russia sanctions list](#) (PDF).

In October 2024, the UK also sanctioned several military figures over the alleged use of chemical weapons on the battlefield in Ukraine. Those sanctions were implemented under the UK’s chemical weapons sanctions regime as opposed to the Russia country regime.³¹

Targeting oligarchs

On the targeting of Russian oligarchs, in February 2022, then Foreign Secretary Liz Truss said:

²⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022; [Press release](#), 16 June 2022; [Press release](#), 26 July 2022

²⁶ The UK sanctions regime against Russia prior to February 2022 is outlined in Library briefing, [Russian sanctions prior to the invasion of Ukraine](#)

²⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 21 April 2022; [Press release](#), 16 June 2022; [Press release](#), 9 December 2022 and [Press release](#), 13 December 2022

²⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 31 March 2022 and [Press release](#), 21 April 2022

²⁹ International Criminal Court, [Statement](#), and [Press release](#), 25 June 2024

³⁰ International Criminal Court, [Statement](#), 5 March 2024

³¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 8 October 2024

We have a hit list of oligarchs and Duma members – those key personnel we are talking about. We will be announcing those as we build the evidence and case against them, but we need those cases to be legally watertight – that is what is important – so that when we hit them, the hit sticks.³²

Since Russia's invasion of Ukraine, the UK has targeted over 130 individuals, with a net worth of over £147 billion, often in concert with the EU and the US.³³ [Many have been designated based on new powers set out in the Economic Crime \(Transparency and Enforcement\) Act 2022](#). All have been identified as having close links to the Kremlin.³⁴

A Russian oligarch is a Russian national who is both ultra-high-net-worth and connected to the Putin regime.

FCDO, [Russia sanctions: notes on designations data](#)

Among the most prominent are:

- Alisher Usmanov – founder of USM Holdings,³⁵ whose sponsorship ties with Everton football club were suspended on 2 March 2022.³⁶ A network of companies and individuals who have enabled Mr Usmanov in evading sanctions have also been designated.³⁷
- Igor Shuvalov – one of Russia's leading oligarchs with significant interests in the UK.³⁸
- Roman Abramovich – former owner of Chelsea FC and stakeholder in Evraz PLC and Norilsk Nickel.³⁹ The US is yet to sanction Mr Abramovich. A network of businessmen closely associated with Mr Abramovich, and those individuals and companies that have assisted in sanctions evasion, have also been sanctioned.⁴⁰
- Oleg Deripaska – shareholder of EN+ group.⁴¹ The US sanctioned Mr Deripaska in 2018.
- Dmitri Lebedev – Chairman of the Board of Directors of Bank Rossiya.⁴² Mr Lebedev has been subject to US sanctions since 2016.
- Boris Borisovich Rotenberg – Son of Boris Rotenberg, who was sanctioned by the UK at the end of February 2022.⁴³

³² HC Deb 28 February 2022, [Sanctions](#) c720

³³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024

³⁴ For announcements of designations see: Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 3 March 2022; [Press release](#), 10 March 2022; [Press release](#), 15 March 2022; [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; [Press release](#), 6 April 2022; [Press release](#), 14 April 2022; [Press release](#), 21 April 2022; [Press release](#), 29 June 2022; [Press release](#), 26 July 2022; [Press release](#), 26 September 2022; [Press release](#), 2 November 2022; [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; [Press release](#), 19 May 2023 and [Press release](#), 8 November 2023

³⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 3 March 2022

³⁶ Everton FC, [Club statement](#), 2 March 2022

³⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 12 April 2023

³⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 3 March 2022

³⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 10 March 2022

⁴⁰ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; [Press release](#), 14 April 2022 and [Press release](#), 12 April 2023

⁴¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 10 March 2022

⁴² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 10 March 2022

⁴³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

- Vladimir Potanin – Russia’s second wealthiest man and a key supporter of the Kremlin. Has acquired Rosbank and shares in Tinkoff Bank since the Russian invasion of Ukraine.⁴⁴

In targeting the assets of oligarchs, and the networks that support them, the Government has also introduced legislation that:

- Bans Russian aircraft from overflying or landing in the UK, and allows the government to detain aircraft, including those owned by oligarchs.⁴⁵ Contravention of these prohibitions is a criminal offence.⁴⁶
- Bans Russian ships from UK ports.⁴⁷
- Prohibits maintenance and technical assistance related to aircraft and ships belonging to specific sanctioned individuals or associated businesses.⁴⁸
- Prevents Russian oligarchs from accessing UK trust services, which allow a person or business to manage the assets of another and are considered “a major element of the UK’s world-class financial services sector that Russia will no longer be able to use”.⁴⁹ Those measures came into force on 16 December 2022.⁵⁰

The government has established a cross-departmental Oligarch Taskforce to “coordinate cross-government work to sanction oligarchs, helping build cases against the list of oligarchs it has identified as targets”.⁵¹

Work is also ongoing, through the government’s new [Economic Deterrence Initiative](#) and its [Economic Crime Plan](#), to support sanctions enforcement and prevent evasion.

In August 2023 the [High Court dismissed a case](#) (PDF), brought by billionaire businessman Eugene Shvidler, appealing [the FCDO’s decision to impose sanctions for his close business association with Roman Abramovich](#). The case was the first appeal against a sanctions designation made under the Russia sanctions regime since February 2022. The High Court determined that the Government’s decision to designate Mr Shvidler was both proportionate and non-discriminatory.⁵²

⁴⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 29 June 2022

⁴⁵ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.6\) Regulations 2022](#)

⁴⁶ HM Treasury, [Explanatory Memorandum to the Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.6\) Regulations 2022 \(PDF\)](#)

⁴⁷ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2022](#) and the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.6\) Regulations 2022](#).

⁴⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 30 March 2022 and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.7\) Regulations 2022](#)

⁴⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 29 June 2022

⁵⁰ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.17\) Regulations 2022](#)

⁵¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 3 March 2022

⁵² Royal Courts of Justice, [Eugene Shvidler v. Secretary of State for Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Affairs, Case No.CO/741/2023 \(PDF\)](#), 18 August 2023

Targeting the facilitators of Russian actions in Ukraine

The government has sanctioned individuals or groups considered to be facilitating Russia's actions in Ukraine, including:

- Russian-installed officials in occupied territories.⁵³
- The Wagner Group, a Russia-based unincorporated private military entity.⁵⁴ The Group had already been [sanctioned by the EU](#) in December 2021 for its activities in Africa. The former Head of the group, the late Yevgeny Prigozhin, was sanctioned by the UK in October 2020.⁵⁵ Russian officials who have actively recruited prisoners into the Wagner Group, in exchange for a presidential pardon, have also been sanctioned,⁵⁶ and in December 2023 sanctions were also placed on actors supporting the wider Wagner network.⁵⁷
- Individuals related to other Russian Private Military Companies and the networks that support them, including PMC Redut which is reported to be involved in the recruitment and deployment of fighters to serve alongside Russian forces in Ukraine.⁵⁸
- Political officials, both in Russia and Ukraine, who have openly supported the Russian invasion, and/or facilitated and enforced Russia's partial mobilisation of up to 300,000 Russian citizens to fight in Ukraine.⁵⁹
- Russian officials and groups involved in the re-education and/or forced deportation of over 19,500 Ukrainian children.⁶⁰ The International Criminal Court issued an arrest warrant for Russia's Children's Rights Commissioner, Maria Lvova-Belova in March 2023 for her alleged role in the forced transfer of Ukrainian children from the Luhansk and Donetsk regions and for facilitating their forced adoption in Russia, which constitutes a war crime under the Rome Statute.⁶¹
- Members of the "Salvation Committee for Peace and Order", an organisation supporting the Russian Army's occupation of the Kherson Oblast.⁶²
- Collaborators in the "[sham](#)" [accession referendums](#) held at the end of September 2022 which led to Russia's subsequent [annexation of four](#)

⁵³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; [Press release](#), 16 June 2022; [Press release](#), 26 July 2022. The Heads of the Donetsk People's Republic and the Luhansk People's Republic, Denis Pushilin and Leonid Pasechnik were already on the UK sanctions list.

⁵⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022

⁵⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 15 October 2020

⁵⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 30 November 2022

⁵⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 December 2023. Two further designations of entities linked to the Wagner Group were also made in June 2024 under the Central African Republic (Sanctions) (EU Exit) Regulations 2019. See Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024

⁵⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2024

⁵⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 21 April 2022; [Press release](#), 16 June 2022; [Press release](#), 26 July 2022; [Press release](#), 30 November 2022 and [Press release](#), 8 February 2023

⁶⁰ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 16 June 2022; [Press release](#), 18 July 2023 and [Press release](#), 19 November 2024

⁶¹ International Criminal Court, [Press release](#), 17 March 2023

⁶² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 16 June 2022

occupied regions of Ukraine: Donetsk, Luhansk, Kherson and Zaporizhzhia. Further designations were also made in September 2023 following the holding of elections in these areas. The UK Government described the elections as an attempt by Russia to “legitimise its illegal control of sovereign Ukrainian territory”. Among those designated is Russia’s Central Election Commission.⁶³

- The Governor of the Russian Central Bank, Elvira Nabiullina, for her role in supporting Russia’s actions in Ukraine and specifically for facilitating the introduction of the rouble as the official currency in the annexed Ukrainian regions.⁶⁴
- Senior executives and the management boards of strategic Russian enterprises.⁶⁵
- Individuals and companies involved in the theft and resale of Ukrainian grain and other agricultural goods.⁶⁶
- Members of the Russian-controlled operating organisation of the Zaporizhzhia Nuclear Power Plant.

The UK has also sanctioned individuals, companies and state organisations involved in facilitating the transfer of weapons and ammunition from North Korea to Russia and in the transfer of ballistic missiles from Iran to Russia.⁶⁷ This is examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions against countries supporting Russia’s invasion of Ukraine](#).

Donation and disclosure of assets

On 19 June 2023, the Government announced that measures would be introduced to:

1. Provide a route for frozen Russian assets to be donated for Ukrainian reconstruction. Further details were expected, although the Government said that the scheme would be voluntary and sanctions relief will not be provided in return for a donation.⁶⁸
2. Require individuals and entities who are designated under the Russia sanctions regime to disclose the assets that they hold in the UK. The failure to disclose assets may lead to further financial penalties or the confiscation of assets.⁶⁹

On 14 December 2023 the Government laid the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#) which enacted the provisions related to asset disclosure. Under the legislation, designated individuals have 10

⁶³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 26 September 2022; [Press release](#), 30 November 2022 and [Press release](#), 29 September 2023

⁶⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022

⁶⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 26 September 2022; [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; [Press release](#), 19 May 2023 and [Press release](#), 22 February 2024

⁶⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

⁶⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2024 [and Press release](#), 10 September 2024

⁶⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office and HM Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 June 2023

⁶⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office and HM Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 June 2023

weeks from the legislation coming into force (26 December 2023), or from the date of designation, whichever is later, to disclose the value and nature of any assets they own, hold or control in the UK. Companies who hold, or suspect that they hold, funds or economic resources for a designated individual must also disclose the nature and value of those funds in an annual report to the Treasury.⁷⁰

In November 2024, changes were made to the UK sanctions regime more broadly that requires all UK persons that hold funds or economic resources of a designated individual, to provide an annual report to the OFSI detailing these assets. Reporting obligations will also be expanded, from May 2025, to include letting agents, insolvency practitioners, art dealers and dealers in high value goods.⁷¹ These requirements will now apply to all UK sanctions regimes, and not just those sanctions related to Russia.

In May 2024, the government indicated that work was still progressing on the donation of assets for reconstruction purposes.⁷²

Financial sanctions

In addition to the measures taken in the first two tranches of sanctions (see Initial sanctions), the Government has imposed numerous rolling sanctions relating to the financial sector. These include restrictions on Russian banks, access to UK financial markets and services, and outward investment in Russia.

Sanctions on banks and financial institutions

As outlined above, one of the first measures the UK took was to freeze the assets of five Russian banks, close to the Kremlin and “involved in bankrolling the Russian occupation”.⁷³

At the end of February 2022 then Foreign Secretary Liz Truss confirmed that “all Russian banks” would be subject to a full asset freeze in due course, including Russia’s largest financial institution Sberbank, which accounts for 35% of Russia’s financial sector.⁷⁴ Subsequent designations of several banks were made on 24 March 2022.⁷⁵ A full asset freeze was imposed on Sberbank and Credit Bank of Moscow on 6 April 2022.⁷⁶ Sberbank was already prohibited from clearing payments in Sterling (see above).

⁷⁰ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#), Amendment of regulation 70 and insertion of regulation 70A. Further information is available from the Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation, [New reporting requirements for designated persons under the Russia regime](#), 12 February 2024

⁷¹ [Sanctions \(EU Exit\) \(Miscellaneous Amendments\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2024](#). See also the [OFSI Blog](#), 14 November 2024

⁷² HL Deb 14 May 2024, [Russia](#), c528

⁷³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2022

⁷⁴ HC Deb 28 February 2022, [Sanctions](#) c710

⁷⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022

⁷⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

The UK has also sanctioned the Russian Direct Investment Fund, a state-owned sovereign wealth fund that the US has referred to as “a known slush fund for President Putin”,⁷⁷ along with the Fund’s CEO, Kirill Dmitriev.⁷⁸

The founders, CEO’s and management boards of sanctioned Russian banks and financial institutions have also been individually designated,⁷⁹ and in April 2022 the UK announced its intention to revoke the recognised status of the Moscow Stock Exchange.⁸⁰

In February 2023, the UK sanctioned a further four Russian banks to “further isolate Russia from the international financial system and help the UK and partners to prevent circumvention”.⁸¹ A further five financial institutions were sanctioned in May 2023.⁸²

In December 2023 the Government confirmed that the prohibition on processing Sterling payments in the UK by designated Russian financial institutions (first introduced in February 2022, see above), will be expanded to other currencies.⁸³

In June 2024 the government announced that a further four Russian financial institutions, including the Moscow Stock Exchange and its CEO Yuri Denisov, the St Petersburg Exchange, the National Clearing Centre and the National Settlement Depository have now been sanctioned, in tandem with action taken in the United States.⁸⁴

So far, the UK has frozen the assets of 29 Russian banks, covering 90% of Russia’s banking sector, and with combined global assets worth £1 trillion.⁸⁵

Exclusion from SWIFT

One measure the Government has been consistently supportive of is Russia’s exclusion from the SWIFT international payments system and, in late February 2022, confirmed the UK was “working with allies to exclude Russia”.⁸⁶

⁷⁷ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 28 February 2022

⁷⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 1 March 2022

⁷⁹ The current list of designated persons is available at: [Financial sanctions, Russia - GOV.UK](#)

⁸⁰ HM Revenue and Customs, [Press release](#), 19 April 2022

⁸¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023

⁸² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

⁸³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 14 December 2023. This measure is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#)

⁸⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024. For the impact of sanctioning the Moscow Stock Exchange, see [“How the latest sanctions will impact Russia and the world”](#), Carnegie Politika, 20 June 2024

⁸⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 18 July 2023; [Press release](#), 29 September 2023 and [Press release](#), 13 June 2024

⁸⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 February 2022

4 What is SWIFT?

The Society for Worldwide Interbank Financial Telecommunication (SWIFT) is [a service that facilitates secure messaging between banks and other financial institutions](#). This enables financial institutions to perform transactions such as payments and settling trades between themselves. However, [it is not, in itself, a payments or settlement system](#).

Swift is used by more than 11,000 institutions in more than 200 countries and territories around the world. Each bank has its own unique SWIFT code. Swift said that [in 2021, it recorded an average of 42 million messages per day](#).

The organisation is [a cooperative society under Belgian law](#) and its [headquarters are in La Hulpe](#), outside Brussels. As a cooperative, it is owned by its members.

Source: House of Lords Library, [Ukraine sanctions and the Swift system](#), 1 March 2022

Several EU Member States, including Germany, had reportedly been initially reluctant to pursue this sanction measure.⁸⁷ Among other things, SWIFT had been used by EU countries to pay for Russian gas imports.⁸⁸

On 2 March 2022 the EU announced that seven Russian banks, already targeted by UK, EU and US sanctions would be excluded from SWIFT (as of 12 March 2022):

- Otkritie
- Novikombank
- Promsvyazbank
- Rossiya Bank
- Sovcombank
- Vnesheconombank
- VTB Bank

That exclusion would also apply to any subsidiaries that are more than 50% owned, either directly or indirectly.⁸⁹

Initially it had been unclear whether expulsions from SWIFT would be a rolling programme. In a press conference on 26 February a senior US administration official said:

⁸⁷ Politico, [“Western leaders agree new Russia sanctions, including SWIFT curbs”](#), 27 February 2022

⁸⁸ This is examined in greater detail in House of Commons Library, [Geopolitical implications of Nord Stream 2](#)

⁸⁹ EU Official Journal, [L63, Vol.65](#), 2 March 2022

we are going to go institution by institution, in terms of those that are removed from the network, and we'll pick those very carefully to maximize the impact on Russia and minimize the spillovers to Europe and the global economy.⁹⁰

In June 2022, Sberbank, the Credit Bank of Moscow and the Russian Agricultural Bank were also excluded from SWIFT.⁹¹

Further designations would have to be approved by the EU.⁹²

In November 2023 the Government said that, as it monitors sanctions and collaborates with international partners to address loopholes and sanctions evasion, it would “continue to isolate Russia’s financial system”.⁹³ That sentiment was reiterated in a statement by G7 leaders in December 2023:

We will work to further curtail Russia’s use of the international financial system to further its war in Ukraine, including Russia’s efforts to use the international financial system to facilitate its expansion of its military industrial base.⁹⁴

Restrictions on the Russian Central Bank

Over 60% of Russia’s central bank foreign reserves have been frozen.

[Lord Ahmad of Wimbledon](#), 14 November 2023

On 26 February 2022, [the EU, UK, US and Canada issued a joint statement](#) which set out their commitment to impose further restrictive measures on Russia.

In addition to removing selected Russian banks from SWIFT (see above), allies also committed to restricting the activities of the Russian Central Bank to prevent it from accessing its foreign reserves as a way of negating the impact of Western-led sanctions and to “undercut its ability to engage in foreign exchange transactions to support the Russian rouble”.⁹⁵

The legislation prohibiting financial services relating to foreign reserves exchange and asset management by the Russian Central Bank is set out in the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.5\) Regulations 2022](#).

On 19 May 2023 the then Foreign Secretary announced that Russian sovereign assets within the UK’s jurisdiction would remain immobilised until Russia agreed to pay reparations to Ukraine.⁹⁶

In June 2023 the government also announced that it was preparing to introduce legislation requiring those holding assets in the UK on behalf of the Russian Central Bank, the Russian Ministry of Finance, or the Russian National Wealth Fund, to disclose them to HM Treasury. Such provisions will assist the

⁹⁰ White House, [Background Press Call](#), 27 February 2022

⁹¹ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 3 June 2022

⁹² SWIFT is headquartered in Belgium and falls under Belgian and EU jurisdiction. Further information on the role of SWIFT is available at: [Swift and sanctions](#)

⁹³ HC Deb, [UK sanctions regime: Russia and Belarus](#), 9 November 2023, c251

⁹⁴ Downing Street, [G7 Leaders’ Statement](#), 6 December 2023

⁹⁵ HM Treasury, [Press release](#), 28 February 2022. Russia was thought to have accumulated more than \$630 billion in currency and gold reserves, which some analysts suggested could keep the Russian economy afloat for a year (Al-Monitor, [“Russian invasion of Ukraine scrambles Middle East diplomacy”](#), 26 February 2022)

⁹⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and development Office, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

Government in obtaining a “comprehensive picture of their value and nature” and in monitoring compliance with financial sanctions.⁹⁷ On 14 December the government subsequently laid the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#) which enact the provisions related to asset disclosure.⁹⁸ This measure is similar to the reporting provisions imposed on EU member states in February 2023 (see [European Union](#)).

Accessing UK financial markets

All Russian companies, including state-owned enterprises such as Gazprom have been prevented from accessing UK capital markets.⁹⁹

Cryptocurrencies

[General guidance from the Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation](#) (OFSI) makes clear that “crypto assets are an economic resource, and as such are caught by financial sanctions regulations”. As such, “attempting to circumvent sanctions using crypto assets is still prohibited in the same way that it would be for any traditional fiat currency”.¹⁰⁰

UK outward investment in Russia

On 6 April the Government announced an outright ban on all new UK investment in Russia. The Government estimates that, in 2020, UK investment in Russia was worth over £11 billion.¹⁰¹ That prohibition was implemented in the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.12\) Regulations 2022](#).

In December 2023, the Government also announced a series of financial measures to support UK businesses who decide to wholly or partially divest themselves of their Russian interests and UK entities that wish to divest themselves of investors who are designated individuals or the Russian government.¹⁰²

Restrictions on the export of banknotes

In July 2022 [legislation was introduced](#) prohibiting the export, supply or delivery to Russia, or a person connected with Russia, of banknotes denominated in Sterling or any official currency of the EU.

Obtaining finance from multilateral institutions

[In a statement on 11 March 2022](#) the countries of the G7, including the UK, said that they would collectively work toward preventing Russia from obtaining finance from leading multilateral institutions, including the International

⁹⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office and HM Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 June 2023

⁹⁸ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#), Amendment of regulation 70 and insertion of regulation 70A.

⁹⁹ HC Deb 28 February 2022, [Sanctions](#) c710

¹⁰⁰ HM Treasury, [Financial sanctions: general guidance](#) (PDF)

¹⁰¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

¹⁰² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 14 December 2022 and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#)

Monetary Fund, the World Bank and the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development. The G7 argue that “Russia cannot grossly violate international law and expect to benefit from being part of the international economic order”.¹⁰³

Transport sanctions

Shipping

The UK has banned all Russian owned, operated, controlled, chartered, registered, or flagged vessels from entering British ports.¹⁰⁴

The UK has also announced sanctions targeting vessels which have been shipping weapons from North Korea to Russia, from Iran to Russia, and those in Russia’s ‘shadow fleet’ that have increasingly been used to circumvent sanctions, in particular the imposition of the price cap on Russian oil exports (see [Imposition of an Oil Price Cap](#)).¹⁰⁵

Airline sector

A UK ban on Russian flag carrier, Aeroflot, was one of the first sanctions measures imposed (see above).

Further measures have been taken to ban all Russian aircraft from overflying or landing in the UK, and to detain aircraft.¹⁰⁶

Russia’s major airlines, Aeroflot, Ural Airlines and Rossiya Airlines, have also been prevented from selling their un-used landing slots at UK airports, which are collectively estimated to be worth £50 million.¹⁰⁷

In February 2024 the UK also designated Russian airline, 224th Flight Unit State Airline, and its director for involvement in the transfer of weapons to Russia from North Korea.¹⁰⁸

Further trade sanctions

Under the Government’s rolling programme of sanctions, restrictive measures against strategic sectors of the Russian economy have been incrementally introduced.

¹⁰³ [G7 statement](#), 11 March 2022

¹⁰⁴ The detail is set out in the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2022](#) and the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.6\) Regulations 2022](#).

¹⁰⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024; [Press release](#) 18 July 2024 and [Press release](#), 10 September 2024. The sanctions imposed in relation to North Korea are examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions against countries supporting Russia’s invasion of Ukraine](#)

¹⁰⁶ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.6\) Regulations 2022](#)

¹⁰⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 19 May 2022

¹⁰⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2024

Those measures have included the designation of individual Russian companies and state-owned enterprises across strategic industries, including defence, aerospace, metals, and energy, including nuclear, oil and liquefied natural gas (LNG), and in many cases their Board of Directors and their immediate family members.¹⁰⁹ In September and October 2024, the government also imposed sanctions on nine vessels and three entities involved in Russia's LNG sector.¹¹⁰ It is the first time that the government has targeted LNG vessels directly after new ship specification powers came into force in May 2024.¹¹¹ In January 2025, the UK, in coordination with the US (see below) also sanctioned Russian energy companies Gazprom and Surgutneftegas, for the first time.¹¹²

To prevent sanctions evasion, Russian importers, shipping companies and international procurement and trade networks comprising individuals and companies operating in third countries, including China, Belarus, Israel, UAE, Turkey, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan and Switzerland, have also increasingly been targeted.¹¹³ Restrictions or prohibitions on the export and import of certain goods and services, including via third countries have also been imposed.

In February 2023 the Government confirmed that all shipping, trade and financial sanctions measures in place against Crimea and non-government-controlled territory in Donetsk and Luhansk, would also be extended to the Russian controlled areas of Kherson and Zaporizhzhia Oblasts.¹¹⁴ Those measures came into force on 20 June 2023.¹¹⁵

¹⁰⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 9 March 2022; [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; [Press release](#), 21 April 2022; [Press release](#), 5 May 2022; [Press release](#), 8 February 2023; [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; [Press release](#), 19 May 2023; [Press release](#), 8 November 2023; [Press release](#), 6 December 2023; [Press release](#), 22 February 2024; [Press release](#), 13 June 2024 and [Press release](#), 7 November 2024. A full list of sanctioned companies is available at: [Financial sanctions, Russia - GOV.UK](#)

¹¹⁰ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 26 September 2024; [Press release](#), 17 October 2024

¹¹¹ The [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2024](#) and the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2024](#).

¹¹² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 10 January 2025

¹¹³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 8 August 2023; HM Treasury, Financial Sanctions Notice, 8 August 2023; Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 8 November 2023; [Press release](#), 6 December 2023; [Press release](#), 22 February 2024; [Press release](#), 13 June 2024 and [Press release](#), 7 November 2024

¹¹⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023

¹¹⁵ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2023](#)

Exports

As of June 2024, there has been a 73% fall in UK exports to Russia.

FCDO, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024

The Government has issued detailed guidance on the key restrictions and exemptions that apply to trade with Russia, including those prohibitions on defence and aerospace announced in the first tranches of sanctions (see above):

- [Russia sanctions: guidance - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)
- [Trading under sanctions with Russia - GOV.UK \(www.gov.uk\)](#)

The Government has also placed prohibitions on the export of:

- **Aviation and space-related goods and technology**, including technical assistance.¹¹⁶ UK companies are also prohibited from providing insurance and re-insurance services in relation to these goods and technology.¹¹⁷
- **Key oil refining equipment and catalysts**, thereby “degrading Russia’s ability to produce and export oil – targeting not only the industry’s finances but its capabilities as a whole”.¹¹⁸ That export ban is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.8\) Regulations 2022](#).
- **Key materials that support Russia’s manufacturing and heavy machinery sectors**, including chemicals, plastics, rubber, and machinery.¹¹⁹
- **Maritime goods and technologies**.¹²⁰
- **High-end luxury goods**, including luxury vehicles, couture fashion and works of art.¹²¹ Prohibitions on the provision of ancillary services related to luxury goods were introduced in December 2023 in the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#).
- **Products and technology used for repression**, including interception and monitoring equipment.¹²²
- **Services**, including management consulting, accounting, public relations,¹²³ IT consultancy (including the design of IT systems and software applications), architectural services, engineering, advertising, auditing and transactional legal advisory services.¹²⁴ In the area of transactional legal services alone, the Russian government is estimated

¹¹⁶ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.6\) Regulations 2022](#)

¹¹⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 9 March 2022

¹¹⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

¹¹⁹ Department for International Trade, [Press release](#), 9 May 2022

¹²⁰ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.11\) Regulations 2022](#)

¹²¹ See [G7 Leaders statement](#), 11 March 2022; Department for International Trade, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022; [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.8\) Regulations 2022](#) and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#)

¹²² Department for Business and Trade, [Press release](#), 25 April 2022

¹²³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 4 May 2022. That ban is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.14\) Regulations 2022](#). Further restrictions are imposed by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.15\) Regulations 2022](#).

¹²⁴ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022. These measures are enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.17\) Regulations 2022](#), which came into force on 16 December 2022.

to import 85% of such services from G7 countries, of which 59% is provided by the UK.¹²⁵

- **Quantum and advanced material technologies.**¹²⁶
- **700 categories of goods “critical for production in Russia’s manufacturing sector”.**¹²⁷ That list is set out in Schedule 2 of the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.15\) Regulations 2022](#).
- **Every item that Russia has been found to be using on the battlefield in Ukraine** to date. That ban is applicable to hundreds of goods including aircraft parts, radio equipment and electronic components that can be used by the Russian defence industrial sector, for example in the productions of UAVs.¹²⁸ A full list of sanctioned items has been compiled in the [Russia sanctions – Common High Priority Items list](#). That list was expanded in February 2024 to include further items critical to Russian weapons systems and Russian military development.¹²⁹

Imports

The Government has taken a two-pronged approach to imports: an outright ban on certain goods or the imposition of additional import tariffs on goods of Russian origin. Those measures also apply to Belarus.

Imports subject to additional tariffs

On 11 March 2022, [the G7 nations issued a statement](#) in which they set out the intention to strip Russia of its [Most-Favoured-Nation \(MFN\) status](#). MFN status is a key benefit of WTO membership and prevents other WTO members discriminating against a country. That step had already been imposed by Canada (see below).

The Government has announced [five separate packages of goods which will be subject to an additional 35% import tariff on top of existing tariffs](#). The most recent measures came into force on 4 December 2023. Among other things, the list includes, iron, steel, fertilisers, wood, copper, aluminium, silver, lead, iron ore, spirits (including vodka), glass, cereals, artworks, antiques, fur skins and artificial fur, ships, white fish, diamonds, platinum and palladium, of which Russia is a major producing country,¹³⁰ and titanium alloy.¹³¹

Import bans

The Government has announced the following import bans:

UK imports from Russia have fallen 99% since the invasion of Ukraine.

Department for Business and Trade, 24 February 2023

¹²⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022

¹²⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

¹²⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022

¹²⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023 and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2023](#). Further amendments were introduced in December 2023 with the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#).

¹²⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 22 February 2024

¹³⁰ Department for International Trade, [Press release](#), 9 May 2022

¹³¹ Department for Business and Trade, [Additional duties on goods originating in Russia and Belarus](#) (accessed 13 December 2023)

- **All iron and steel products.**¹³² Further restrictions have been introduced relating to the provision of technical assistance, financial services and funds, and the brokering of services that enable both the supply of iron and steel products from Russia to a third country, and the acquisition of such products originating from Russia but processed in a third country.¹³³
- **Silver, wood products, and high-end goods** such as caviar.¹³⁴
- **Russian gold**, the country's largest non-energy export market in 2021 at £12.6 billion.¹³⁵ Further restrictions have been introduced on the import of **gold processed in third countries** and on **gold jewellery**.¹³⁶
- **Coal** - the intention was to align that measure with the ban on oil imports.¹³⁷ However, the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.14\) Regulations 2022](#) made provision for the ban on Russian coal to come into force on 10 August 2022, in line with requisite EU measures.
- **Russian origin oil and oil products** - On 8 March 2022, the Prime Minister announced that the UK would phase out Russian oil imports by the end of 2022.¹³⁸ Russian imports of oil accounted for 8% of the UK's total demand at the time.¹³⁹ The import ban on Russian-origin oil and oil products came into force on 5 December 2022.¹⁴⁰ Measures to impose a price cap on Russian oil is examined below.
- **Gas** - In March 2022 the Government indicated that it would look to end the UK's import of Russian gas, which, at the time, made up only 4% of UK supply.¹⁴¹ A ban on all imports of Russian liquefied natural gas (LNG) came into force on 1 January 2023.¹⁴²
- **A further 140 goods, including iron and steel products, processed in third countries.**¹⁴³
- **Diamonds and diamond jewellery**– On 18 May 2023 the UK announced an import ban on Russian-origin diamonds.¹⁴⁴ Aside from Russian imports

¹³² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022. That ban is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.8\) Regulations 2022](#).

¹³³ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.11\) Regulations 2022](#) and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2023](#). That latter measure came into force on 30 September 2023. Further amendments were introduced in December 2023 with the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#)

¹³⁴ Department for International Trade, [Press release](#), 21 April 2022. That ban is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.11\) Regulations 2022](#).

¹³⁵ Downing Street, [Press release](#), 26 June 2022. That ban is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.14\) Regulations 2022](#).

¹³⁶ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.15\) Regulations 2022](#) and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2023](#)

¹³⁷ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

¹³⁸ Downing Street, [Press release](#), 8 March 2022. The UK's initial decision mirrored that of the United States, which announced [a ban on the import of Russian oil, liquefied natural gas and coal](#). The EU also announced its plan to reduce dependence on Russian energy by 2030.

¹³⁹ Downing Street, [Press release](#), 8 March 2022

¹⁴⁰ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.14\) Regulations 2022](#), as amended by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.16\) Regulations 2022](#)

¹⁴¹ Department for Business, Energy and Industrial Strategy, [Press release](#), 9 March 2022

¹⁴² That ban is enacted by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.15\) Regulations 2022](#). Library research briefing: [Imports of fossil fuels from Russia](#) examines this issue in more detail

¹⁴³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023 and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2023](#)

¹⁴⁴ Downing Street, [Press release](#), 18 May 2023

to the US, which were banned in March 2022, this sector of the Russian economy had only been subject to limited sanctions such as the imposition of additional import tariffs and the sanctioning of state-owned diamond company Alrosa. Legislation bringing this ban into effect, along with a prohibition on the provision of ancillary services, was introduced on 14 December 2023, with a view to a ban from 1 January 2024.¹⁴⁵ Further restrictions on Russian-origin diamonds processed in third countries were to be introduced by 1 March 2024.¹⁴⁶ Critics have argued, however, that a ban on Russian diamonds will have limited utility unless India, a major destination for Russian diamonds which are then cut and polished before re-exporting, supports such sanctions.¹⁴⁷

- **Russian-origin copper, nickel and aluminium.**¹⁴⁸ To strengthen the prohibition on Russian metal exports, in April 2024 the US and the UK announced that the world's two largest metal exchanges: the London Metal Exchange and the Chicago Mercantile Exchange would be brought into the scope of the existing bans. Both exchanges will no longer trade in new aluminium, coppers and nickel produced in Russia. The ban does not apply however to the trade in titanium and platinum group metals which are not subject to a UK import ban, although they are subject to additional import tariffs (see above).¹⁴⁹

Imposition of an Oil Price Cap and targeting Russia's "shadow fleet"

Since imposition of the oil price cap, there has been a 30% reduction in tax from Russian oil revenues in 2023 compared to 2022.

HM Government, [UK support to Ukraine](#) (PDF), December 2024

Following a meeting of Finance Ministers in early September 2022, the countries of the G7 announced their intention to "finalise and implement a comprehensive prohibition of services which enable maritime transportation of Russian-origin crude oil and petroleum products globally" unless such products are purchased at, or below, a designated price cap. The aim of introducing a price cap was to "reduce Russian revenues and Russia's ability to fund its war of aggression whilst limiting the impact of Russia's war on global energy prices, particularly for low and middle-income countries".¹⁵⁰

The G7 has been seeking to establish a "broad coalition" to maximise the effectiveness of this measure and urges all countries that intend to continue importing Russian oil and petroleum products "to commit to doing so only at prices at or below the price cap".¹⁵¹

¹⁴⁵ [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.5\) Regulations 2023](#). In the [G7 Leaders' statement of December 2023](#), the G7 countries said import restrictions on diamonds mined, processed or produced in Russia would be imposed by 1 January 2024, with further restrictions on Russian-origin diamonds processed in third countries, by 1 March 2024.

¹⁴⁶ Legislation was introduced in February 2024: [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) Regulations 2024](#)

¹⁴⁷ "Ukraine war: Russian diamonds set for ban under new EU sanctions", BBC News, 15 November 2023

¹⁴⁸ Downing Street, [Press release](#), 18 May 2023. That prohibition was brought into effect in December 2023 with the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2023](#)

¹⁴⁹ HM Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 April 2024

¹⁵⁰ [G7 statement of Finance Ministers](#), 2 September 2022

¹⁵¹ [G7 statement of Finance Ministers](#), 2 September 2022

In the UK, the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.16\) Regulations 2022](#) enact the measures necessary to prohibit access to UK vessels and services, such as insurance, used for the transportation of Russian oil and oil products globally, unless such products are purchased at, or below, an agreed price cap.¹⁵² The regulations also confer on the Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation (OFSI), the power to impose civil monetary penalties on any person who fails to comply with these new measures.

This measure, in coordination with the EU and US, came into force on 5 December 2022 for Russian-origin oil and 5 February 2023 for Russian-origin oil products such as petroleum.¹⁵³

In response, the Russian government announced that it would cut crude oil production by 500,000 barrels per day from March 2023 and would not trade with any countries imposing the price cap.¹⁵⁴

Since the end of 2022, the G7 countries have introduced several measures intended to strengthen the existing Oil Price Cap and prevent evasion.¹⁵⁵ Sanctions have been introduced against individuals and companies, including insurance brokers, facilitating the trade in Russian oil and oil products outside of the Oil Price Cap, including through third countries such as UAE.¹⁵⁶ Recent efforts have increasingly focused on targeting Russia's shadow fleet. These are ageing vessels with obscure ownership which are uninsured and often environmentally unsound, which are being used to transport sanctioned Russian crude oil and related oil products around the globe, outside of the Oil Price Cap. An assessment by the Center for Strategic and International Studies in January 2025 suggested that, by mid-2024, Russia's shadow fleet was responsible for transporting over 70% of Russia's oil and its by-products globally.¹⁵⁷

Targeting Russia's shadow fleet

In June 2024 the UK Government announced the first set of sanctions against specified vessels of Russia's 'shadow fleet'.¹⁵⁸ The Foreign, Commonwealth

¹⁵² \$60 per barrel for crude oil, \$100 for high-value products such as diesel and gasoline and \$45 for lower value products such as fuel oil (HM Treasury, [Press release](#), 3 February 2023)

¹⁵³ US Department of the Treasury, [Preliminary guidance on the implementation of a maritime services policy and related price exception for seaborne Russian oil \(PDF\)](#), 9 September 2022

¹⁵⁴ ["Russia to send most 2023 oil exports to friendly countries after output cut announcement"](#), S&P Global, 13 February 2023

¹⁵⁵ [Statement of the G7 and Australia on Actions Taken to Enforce Price Caps for Seaborne Russian-Origin Oil and Petroleum Products \(PDF\)](#), October 2023 and HM Treasury, [Price Cap Coalition Compliance and Enforcement Alert](#), February 2024

¹⁵⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 8 November 2023; [Press release](#), 22 February 2024; [Press release](#), 25 November 2024 and [Press release](#), 17 December 2024

¹⁵⁷ Center for Strategic and International Studies, [How to exorcise Russia's ghost fleet](#), 7 January 2025

¹⁵⁸ Enabled by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2024](#), Ships specified under the regulations are prohibited from entering a port in the UK, may be given a movement or port entry direction, can be detained, will be refused permission to register on the UK Ship Register or have its existing registration terminated, and are prohibited from accessing financial and

and Development Office said the purpose of targeting specified vessels was to “disrupt and increase the costs of Russia’s efforts to bypass UK and G7 sanctions through its shadow fleet”.¹⁵⁹

A call to action

At a meeting of the European Political Community in July 2024, the government launched [a Call to Action](#) (PDF) to address the risks posed by Russia’s shadow fleet, not just in enabling sanctions evasion, but for the risks that these vessels [pose to maritime and environmental security](#). Forty-four countries and the European Union endorsed the action plan at that meeting, which will see greater coordination between countries in their efforts to disrupt the fleet.¹⁶⁰ The US, Canada, Australia, Japan and New Zealand have since signed the Call to Action bringing the number of signatories to 49.¹⁶¹

Further sanctions

UK sanctions designations on vessels in Russia’s shadow fleet continue to be made.¹⁶²

Separately, the Department of Transport is also working alongside the [Joint Maritime Security Centre](#) and the Maritime and Coastguard Agency to challenge suspected shadow fleet vessels to provide details of their insurance status as they pass through UK waters.¹⁶³ In December 2024, the UK, Denmark, Sweden, Poland, Estonia and Finland agreed a new partnership to challenge suspected vessels along the Baltic route.¹⁶⁴

Following the latest round of designations in December 2024, the number of shadow fleet vessels sanctioned by the UK currently stands at 93, which is more than any other nation.¹⁶⁵

The FCDO has estimated that the shadow fleet, made up of approximately 600 vessels, carries around 1.7 million barrels of Russian oil per day, generating significant revenue for the Russian Government.¹⁶⁶

brokering services, including insurance, from UK providers (Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024 and [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.2\) Regulations 2024: Explanatory memorandum](#) (PDF), May 2024). Those regulations were replaced in July 2024 by the [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2024](#), but did not implement any new measures.

¹⁵⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 13 June 2024

¹⁶⁰ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 18 July 2024

¹⁶¹ HM Government, [The Shadow fleet: a call to action](#), 28 November 2024

¹⁶² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 18 July 2024; [Press release](#), 11 September 2024; [Press release](#), 17 October 2024; [Press release](#), 25 November 2024 and [Press release](#), 17 December 2024

¹⁶³ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 17 October 2024

¹⁶⁴ Prime Minister’s Office, [Joint Statement by the Nordic-Baltic 8++ countries](#), 16 December 2024

¹⁶⁵ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 17 December 2024

¹⁶⁶ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 18 July 2024

Joint Expeditionary Force monitoring

In January 2025 the government announced that the UK-led Joint Expeditionary Force (JEF) had activated Operation Nordic Warden, which will track potential threats to undersea infrastructure and monitor the movements of Russia's shadow fleet.¹⁶⁷ The operation was activated after damage to an undersea cable in the Baltic Sea, which the Finnish Government said was caused by a vessel from Russia's shadow fleet.¹⁶⁸

Enforcement of trade sanctions– creation of the Office of Trade Sanctions Implementation (OTSI)

Enforcement of sanctions against Russia, or the lack of it, has been a particular concern.¹⁶⁹

On 11 December 2023, the government announced the creation of a new [Office of Trade Sanctions Implementation \(OTSI\)](#) to strengthen the UK's implementation and enforcement of trade sanctions. The new unit sits within the Department of Business and Trade and is responsible for enforcement of the provision of sanctioned services and the trade in sanctioned goods and services anywhere else in the world where a UK company or person is involved (for example sanctions evasion through third countries). It is also responsible for the civil enforcement of trade sanctions, including those against Russia.¹⁷⁰

HMRC will remain responsible for enforcing trade sanctions that relate to the import or export of goods or technology to, or from, the UK or their associated ancillary services and those goods and technologies which are subject to strategic export controls, such as military and dual-use goods. Criminal enforcement of trade sanctions offences will also remain the remit of HMRC.¹⁷¹

The OTSI was launched in October 2024.¹⁷²

The [Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation \(OFSI\)](#) within HM Treasury will remain responsible for the enforcement of financial sanctions.

At the end of 2024 the government also announced a cross-departmental review of sanctions enforcement. In a statement to the House of Commons, Minister of State for Europe, North America and the Overseas Territories Stephen Doughty said:

I will use the review to consider where we can go further and deeper to improve our sanctions system. I want us to look at how we can make our sanctions

¹⁶⁷ Ministry of Defence, [Press release](#), 6 January 2025

¹⁶⁸ European Union External Action Service, [Joint Statement](#), 26 December 2024

¹⁶⁹ “[Russia sanctions: fears over UK enforcement by HMRC](#)”, Sky News, 17 January 2025; “[No convictions for breaching sanctions on Russia](#)”, BBC News, 17 January 2025 and Spotlight on Corruption, [All bark and no bite?: Taking stock of the UK's enforcement of sanctions](#), July 2024

¹⁷⁰ See [The Trade, Aircraft, and Shipping Sanctions \(Civil Enforcement\) Regulations 2024](#)

¹⁷¹ [Office of Trade Sanctions Implementation, About us](#) (accessed 20 January 2025)

¹⁷² Department for Business and Trade, [Press release](#), 10 October 2024

easier to comply with, how we can build our cross-government capabilities to combat sanctions circumvention and how we can expand and improve our sanctions toolkit. I look forward to substantially enhancing enforcement efforts and reporting the outcomes to Parliament.¹⁷³

5 Further guidance on trade sanctions

For further guidance on import and export restrictions and the oil price cap, see:

- Office for Trade Sanctions Implementation, [Guidance: Countering Russian sanctions evasion and circumvention](#)
- Office for Trade Sanctions Implementation, [Guidance: Trading under sanctions with Russia](#)
- Department for Business and Trade, [Additional duties on goods originating in Russia and Belarus](#)
- Department for Business and Trade: [NTI2953, Russia import sanctions](#)
- HM Treasury, [UK maritime services ban and oil price cap: Industry guidance](#), June 2024
- HM Treasury, [Russian oil services ban](#)
- [Updated Price Cap Coalition Advisory for the Maritime Oil Industry and related sectors](#) (PDF), October 2024

The government has also established an Export Support Team to help UK businesses trading with Ukraine, Russia and Belarus. An online query service is available at: [Tell us how we can help – GOV.UK \(get-help-selling-goods-services-abroad.service.gov.uk\)](#)

Accessing legal services

The provision of legal services was already partially restricted in relation to sanctioned goods and technologies (see above). However, because of the territorial application of the regulations, these restrictions generally only apply to legal services that are undertaken in the UK or by a UK person.

Therefore, at the end of June 2023, the Government introduced legislation that will extend the prohibition on providing legal advisory services to Russian individuals and companies. Under the new regulations UK legal professionals, or any person based in the UK, will be prohibited from providing legal advisory services to international financial and trade activities linked to Russia, such as trade deals between global corporations or international money lending to Russian businesses. [The Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2023](#) came into force on 30 June 2023.

The legislation does not, however, cover legal representation services for non-UK nationals. The Government notes that “access to legal representation

¹⁷³ HCWS334, [UK sanctions](#), 18 December 2024

is an important element of the core democratic principle of the rule of law, and this sort of legal service has therefore been excluded”.¹⁷⁴

An exception has also been provided for auditing services where they are required to fulfil statutory or regulatory obligations.¹⁷⁵

In September 2024 the Russia (Sanctions (EU Exit) (Amendment) (No.4) Regulations were introduced to provide clarity to this policy. The government’s explanatory memorandum states that the regulations put “beyond doubt that legal advice in relation to compliance with global sanctions and criminal legislation is permitted”.¹⁷⁶

Targeting disinformation

As the outset of the conflict, calls were made for Russian state-owned media outlet, RT (formerly Russia Today), to be banned from broadcasting in the UK. On 27 February 2022, the EU confirmed that RT, and some other state-owned media, would be banned, which indirectly led to RT being taken off the air in the UK. Ofcom subsequently revoked RT’s broadcasting licence on 18 March 2022.¹⁷⁷

The UK has since taken steps to sanction Russian state media, social media platforms, propagandists, news anchors, and regime spokespeople accused of spreading disinformation about the conflict. Several of those individuals were already sanctioned under EU and US regimes and were initially sanctioned under powers provided by the [Economic Crime \(Transparency and Enforcement\) Act 2022](#).¹⁷⁸

Among the more prominent are:

- Dmitry Peskov, President Putin’s Press Secretary.¹⁷⁹
- Maria Zakharova, Spokesperson for the Russian Ministry of Foreign Affairs.¹⁸⁰
- TV Novosti, which owns RT (formerly Russia Today) and Rossiya Segodnya, which controls news agency Sputnik.¹⁸¹
- The Social Design Agency, which is directly funded and tasked by the Russian Government to deliver interference operations with the aim of

¹⁷⁴ [Explanatory Memorandum to the Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2023 \(PDF\)](#), June 2023

¹⁷⁵ [Explanatory Memorandum to the Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.3\) Regulations 2023 \(PDF\)](#), June 2023

¹⁷⁶ [Explanatory Memorandum to the Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(No.4\) Regulations 2024 \(PDF\)](#)

¹⁷⁷ Ofcom, [Press release](#), 18 March 2022. This is examined in greater detail in House of Commons Library briefing, [Countering Russian influence in the UK](#)

¹⁷⁸ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022; [Press release](#), 31 March 2022; [Press release](#), 4 May 2022; [Press release](#), 8 February 2023; [Press release](#), 18 July 2023 and [Press release](#), 28 October 2024

¹⁷⁹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022

¹⁸⁰ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022

¹⁸¹ Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 31 March 2022

undermining democracy worldwide and to weaken international support for Ukraine.¹⁸²

The [Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.9\) Regulations](#), which came into force on 29 April 2022, also introduce requirements on all social media services, including video sharing platforms, to take “reasonable steps” to prevent content being disseminated on that service by a person subject to sanctions (a designated person). Internet access services, including broadband providers, and app stores must also take reasonable steps to prevent users in the UK from accessing websites and downloading or accessing applications provided by a designated person.

The regulations also confer powers on Ofcom to impose monetary penalties on any person who fails to comply. Non-compliance is also a criminal offence.¹⁸³

Humanitarian exemptions

On 7 July 2022 the Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation issued a [Humanitarian Activity General Licence](#) under the Russia sanctions regime.

In recognition of the fact that humanitarian activities, including the delivery of aid to Ukraine, may inadvertently be affected by the increasing number of sanctions designations being made by the Government, a General Licence has been issued which provides a blanket permission for the delivery of humanitarian assistance to Ukraine. Humanitarian actors will no longer have to apply for individual licences. However, there are a number of conditions:

- Permissions only extend to an approved category of organisations.
- Funds for humanitarian assistance must not be funds or economic resources that are owned, held or controlled by a sanctioned individual, thereby preventing them from circumventing sanctions.¹⁸⁴

6 Useful information

- HM Government, [Russia sanctions: Guidance](#), December 2024
- HM Treasury, [Financial sanctions guidance for Russia](#), December 2024
- Department for Business and Trade, [Trading under sanctions with Russia](#)
- HM Treasury, [Financial sanctions: Russia](#)
- Office for Financial Sanctions Implementation Blog, [Strengthening global sanctions: Two years of enhanced partnership](#), 19 November 2024
- Office for Financial Sanctions Implementation, [Annual Review 2022 to 2023: Strengthening our sanctions](#), 14 December 2023

¹⁸² Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Press release](#), 28 October 2024. See also US Department of State, [Media note](#), 28 October 2024

¹⁸³ [Explanatory memorandum to Russia \(Sanctions\) \(EU Exit\) \(Amendment\) \(No.9\) Regulations 2022](#), para. 7.6

¹⁸⁴ Office for Financial Sanctions Implementation, [Blog](#), 7 July 2022

- National Crime Agency and OFSI, [Red alert: Exporting high risk goods \(PDF\)](#), December 2023
- Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [UK sanctions relating to Russia](#)
- Foreign, Commonwealth and Development Office, [Russia sanctions – Common High Priority Items list](#) (last updated August 2024). This list comprises those Western items that Russia is using in its weapon systems. All items are subject to UK sanctions.
- HM Treasury and US Department of the Treasury, [Humanitarian assistance and food security fact sheet \(PDF\)](#), June 2023
- Office for National Statistics, [The impact of sanctions on UK trade with Russia: November 2022](#)

3

Coordinating with allies

Sanctions and export controls against Russia are being implemented by a coalition that includes more than 30 countries around the globe, who represent more than 50% of the global economy.¹⁸⁵ The US has described the coordination between allies on sanctions measures against Russia as an “unprecedented act of global sanctions coordination”.¹⁸⁶

There are, however, several countries, including China, India, Iran, the United Arab Emirates, Israel and Saudi Arabia who do not support unilateral sanctions against Russia.¹⁸⁷ Turkey, which is a NATO Member State, and Serbia, which is an EU candidate country, have also refused to implement sanctions.¹⁸⁸

There have also been differences between the respective sanction regimes, particularly over the individuals that have been sanctioned, the strategic sectors of Russia’s economy that have been targeted, the willingness to sanction third country entities, or the timing of those designations.¹⁸⁹ This has, in part, been due to the different legal frameworks each country is operating in, the reliance of certain countries, particularly in the EU, on various Russian exports such as gas, nuclear energy and metals, and the extent of Russian sanctions already in place within each jurisdiction prior to 2022. The passage of the [Economic Crime \(Transparency and Enforcement\) Act 2022](#) has allowed the UK to immediately designate individuals and entities that have already been sanctioned by the EU, US and other allies, under emergency procedures.

In an effort to ensure greater coordination of sanctions and their implementation, the countries of the G7 and the EU, along with other allies and partners, have established [the Russian Elites Proxies and Oligarchs \(REPO\) Task Force](#) to identify and freeze the assets of sanctioned individuals and companies, within their respective jurisdictions, and to ensure assets are not hidden in jurisdictions across the world. A Sanctions Coordinators Forum

¹⁸⁵ US Department of the Treasury, [Remarks by Deputy Secretary of the Treasury Wally Adeyemo](#), 18 April 2022

¹⁸⁶ White House, [Background Press Call](#), 27 February 2022

¹⁸⁷ See Middle East Institute, [“The divided regional response to Russia’s invasion”](#), 28 February 2022 and Washington Examiner, [“Which countries have decided not to sanction Russia?”](#), 3 March 2022

¹⁸⁸ Politico, [“Pandering to Putin comes back to bite Serbia’s Vučić”](#), 7 March 2022; TASS, [“Turkey will not join sanctions against Russia- Erdogan”](#), 25 March 2022 and CNBC, [“Russian oligarchs are welcome in Turkey, Foreign Minister says”](#), 26 March 2022

¹⁸⁹ See for example, Financial Times, [“Why the US has hit some Russian oligarchs with sanctions but not others”](#), 14 April 2022

has also been established under the chairmanship of the EU Sanctions Envoy.¹⁹⁰

This section looks at the sanction measures introduced since February 2022 by the United States, the EU and other allies including Canada and Australia.

The debate around coordinated efforts to seize sanctioned Russian assets is examined in Library research briefing: [Sanctions, international law and seizing Russian assets](#).

3.1

United States

The US imposed an extensive sanctions regime in 2014 following Russia's annexation of Crimea and its support of ongoing destabilisation in eastern Ukraine. Such measures targeted Russia's defence and energy sectors, financial institutions, individuals within Putin's inner circle, including numerous oligarchs, while also prohibiting export financing and economic development projects in Russia.¹⁹¹

Initial sanctions – February 2022

“Over the last two years, the Departments of Treasury and State have designated over 4,000 entities and individuals pursuant to Russia-related sanctions authorities”.

[US Department of the Treasury](#), 23 February 2024

In immediate response to the Russian recognition of the DPR and LPR, [President Biden signed an Executive Order prohibiting new trade, investment and financing in the DPR and LPR](#) and providing for sanctions to be imposed against anyone operating in those regions. The White House said the measures were solely a response to “Russia’s recognition gambit” and did not represent the “swift and severe economic measures” that were being discussed with allies should Russia invade Ukraine.¹⁹²

A [package of initial sanctions measures was then announced by the US administration](#) on 22 February 2022, including the expansion of sovereign debt prohibitions, the targeting of several oligarchs and sanctions against a number of financial institutions and their subsidiaries. The US Treasury also determined that any institution in the Russian financial services sector would be a target for future sanctions.¹⁹³

¹⁹⁰ European Commission, [Press release](#), 23 February 2023

¹⁹¹ US Department of State Archive, [Ukraine and Russia sanctions](#) (accessed 19 May 2023)

¹⁹² White House, [Statement by Press Secretary Jen Psaki on Russian announcement on eastern Ukraine](#), 21 February 2022

¹⁹³ The US administration estimated that over 80% of Russia's daily foreign exchange transactions globally are in US dollars and half of Russia's international trade is conducted in US dollars (White House, [Fact Sheet: United States imposes first tranche of swift and severe costs on Russia](#), 22 February 2022)

The US also reinstated sanctions on Nord Stream 2 AG, the company that owns the pipeline, and its CEO, Matthias Warnig, which it had waived in May 2021 (see A halt to Nord Stream 2).¹⁹⁴

When announcing the sanctions, President Biden warned:

As Russia contemplates its next move, we have our next move prepared as well. Russia will pay an even steeper price if it continues its aggression, including additional sanctions.¹⁹⁵

Rolling sanctions

In concert with allies within the G7 and the EU, the US has implemented extensive sanctions measures since February 2022. Initially in response to the Russian invasion, but also in response to Russian military escalation or significant events such as the annexation of Ukrainian territory, to mark the anniversaries of the invasion and in response to the death of Russian opposition figure Alexei Navalny.

However, the US has also introduced sanctions packages at various points to bring it into closer alignment with measures introduced in the UK and EU.¹⁹⁶

The US Justice Department has established Task Force KleptoCapture, an interagency law enforcement taskforce dedicated to implementation of the US sanctions regime against Russia.¹⁹⁷

In common with allies, the US has increasingly focused its attention on tackling sanctions evasion.

In January 2025, the US Department of the Treasury also re-designated hundreds of companies and individuals already subject to US sanctions, including [financial institutions](#) and companies operating in the [defence](#) and [energy](#) sectors, under [Executive Order 13662](#) which authorises sanctions related to Ukraine and Russia under the [Countering America's Adversaries Through Sanctions Act](#).¹⁹⁸ In doing so, any individual, including foreign financial institutions, that knowingly facilitate transactions for, or on behalf of, any designated persons could be subject to mandatory secondary US sanctions.¹⁹⁹ Under this law, Congress must also be consulted if the President

¹⁹⁴ US Department of State, [Sanctioning NS2 AG](#), 23 February 2022

¹⁹⁵ White House, [Remarks by President Biden announcing response to Russian actions in Ukraine](#), 22 February 2022

¹⁹⁶ See: US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2022 and [Russia-related designations](#), 24 February 2022; US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 7 April 2022; US State Department, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022 and US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022; US Department of State, [Press statement](#), 24 February 2023, US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 24 February 2023 and US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023 and [Press release](#), 23 February 2024

¹⁹⁷ US Department of Justice, [Press release](#), 2 March 2022

¹⁹⁸ US Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 January 2025

¹⁹⁹ As above

wants to lift these specific sanctions. The move has been described by some observers as an attempt to “Trump-proof” the Russia sanctions regime should President Trump seek to provide some sanctions relief to Russia if it agrees to peace talks.²⁰⁰ At the same time, the Biden administration imposed sweeping sanctions on Russia’s energy sector which US officials described as giving the next administration “a stronger hand heading into any talks with Putin over ending the war”.²⁰¹

- The US sanctions list is searchable via: [Sanctions List Search \(treas.gov\)](https://www.treas.gov/sanctions)

Designation of the Russian leadership

On 25 February 2022, the US announced sanctions on President Putin and Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov. It also sanctioned then Russian defence minister Sergei Shoigu and Chief of the General Staff of the Russian Armed Forces Valery Gerasimov.²⁰²

Subsequent sanctions have targeted the remaining member of the National Security Council, government ministers, high-ranking Kremlin officials, and members of the Russian Parliament.²⁰³ The US has also designated the Russian Duma as an entity in its own right.²⁰⁴

The US has also sanctioned the family members of Putin, Lavrov and other Russian elites.²⁰⁵

Oligarchs and Putin’s inner circle

Russian oligarchs not already on the US sanctions list prior to 2022 have been incrementally sanctioned.²⁰⁶ The notable exception is Roman Abramovich who has not been personally sanctioned by the US, in contrast to the UK and EU.

²⁰⁰ “US announces ‘Trump-proof’ sanctions against Russia”, The Financial Times, 15 January 2025

²⁰¹ “Biden takes parting shot at Russian economy with sweeping oil sanctions”, Politico Pro (subscription required), 12 January 2025

²⁰² US State Department, [Imposing sanctions on President Putin and three other senior Russian officials](#), 25 February 2022

²⁰³ US State Department, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 7 April 2022; US Department of State, [Press statement](#), 2 August 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022 and [Press release](#), 2 November 2023

²⁰⁴ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022

²⁰⁵ US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 7 April 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 2 August 2022

²⁰⁶ White House, [Fact Sheet: United States imposes first tranche of swift and severe costs on Russia](#), 22 February 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Russia-related designations](#), 3 March 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 June 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 2 June 2022; US Department of State, [Press statement](#), 2 August 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 2 August 2022; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 15 December 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 December 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 11 August 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023 and US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 December 2023

To enforce sanctions and prevent circumvention, enablers, family members and evasion networks linked to sanctioned oligarchs, including in the UK, have been increasingly targeted.²⁰⁷ The US has also identified several vessels and aircraft in which sanctioned individuals, including President Putin, maintain an interest.²⁰⁸

Facilitators of the Russian invasion and subsequent occupation

In addition to political decision makers, the US has sanctioned those individuals and companies that have enabled Russia's invasion of Ukraine, including:

- Russian-installed or supported officials in the annexed regions of Ukraine.²⁰⁹ Visa restrictions have also been imposed on associated family members.²¹⁰
- Individuals and organisations working in collaboration with Russia to undermine stability in the annexed regions, including the Salvation Committee for Peace and Order, the Russia-based Interregional Social Organization Union of Donbas Volunteers (UDV), which is recruiting and deploying fighters in support of Russian military units in the Donbas; the neo-Nazi paramilitary group, Task Force Rusich, which has been identified as participating alongside Russian forces in Ukraine; Russian private military companies Redut²¹¹ and PMC Convoy,²¹² and individuals and entities linked to the mercenary Wagner Group and its former leader Yevgeny Prigozhin, which has been operating extensively in Ukraine.²¹³ In an effort to degrade the actions of the Wagner Group, the US has also [designated the group as a Transnational Criminal Organization](#).²¹⁴
- Russian military leaders and personnel, including those who have been implicated in human rights abuses or violations of international humanitarian law. Thousands of Russian military personnel have also had visa restrictions imposed.²¹⁵ In May 2024 the US sanctioned several Russian military personnel, Russian state institutions and companies with links to Russia's chemical and biological weapons programmes,

²⁰⁷ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 2 June 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 26 January 2023; [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 3 November 2023; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024; Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 14 May 2024; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 12 June 2024; [Press release](#), 4 December 2024 and [Fact Sheet](#), 15 January 2025

²⁰⁸ Ships/aircraft US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 2 June 2022

²⁰⁹ US State Department, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 15 December 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023 and US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024

²¹⁰ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 8 May 2022

²¹¹ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023

²¹² US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024

²¹³ US Department of State, [Factsheet](#), 2 August 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 September 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 26 January 2023

²¹⁴ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 26 January 2023

²¹⁵ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 8 May 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 20 November 2023 and [Fact Sheet](#), 30 October 2024

after the US accused Russia of using chemical weapons against Ukrainian forces.²¹⁶

- Officials and regional governors responsible for mass conscription and the recruitment of prisoners to the Wagner Group.²¹⁷
- Russia's Federal Security Service (FSB), which is already sanctioned under the Countering America's Adversaries through Sanctions Act. The FSB is alleged to be directly involved in the forcible relocation of Ukrainian citizens to Russian-controlled territory or to Russia itself and the running of [filtration camps, whereby Ukrainian civilians are subject to search and interrogation to ascertain any links to the Ukrainian government or military](#).²¹⁸ In December 2022 a further four individuals were sanctioned for their alleged involvement in filtration operations.²¹⁹
- Russian Children's Commissioner Maria Lvova-Belova, and other individuals and entities, for their role in the forcible transfer, deportation, re-education, and adoption of Ukrainian children and related human rights abuses. In February 2024, the US sanctioned the Russian Ambassador to Belarus for his involvement in transferring Ukrainian children to Russia, through Belarus.²²⁰ Further visa restrictions were imposed on officials and regional authorities in December 2024.²²¹
- Individuals identified as supporting, or enabling, the theft of Ukrainian grain harvests on behalf of Russia.²²²
- Officials and organisations responsible for overseeing independence referendums in the four annexed regions of Ukraine, including Russia's Central Election Commission, and all its members.²²³
- Those individuals engaged in Russia's illegitimate control of the Zaporizhzhia Nuclear Power Plant.²²⁴
- 31 foreign government officials have also been designated for their support of Russia's annexation of Crimea.²²⁵
- Several Russian entities and individuals responsible for the militarisation and indoctrination of schoolchildren, including the All Russian Children's and Youth Military Patriotic Public Movement Youth Army, the State Budgetary Educational Institution of Additional Education of the Republic of Crimea Patriot Center and the leaders of the All Russian Public State

²¹⁶ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 1 May 2024

²¹⁷ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 15 December 2022 and US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 December 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 26 January 2023;

²¹⁸ US State Department, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022

²¹⁹ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 9 December 2022

²²⁰ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 September 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 9 December 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023; [Factsheet](#), 24 August 2023; [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024 and Press release,

²²¹ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 4 December 2024

²²² US Department of State, [Fact sheet](#), 15 September 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023 and US Department of State, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

²²³ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 9 December 2022

²²⁴ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023 and US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 15 January 2025

²²⁵ US Department of State, [Press statement](#), 2 August 2022 and US Department of State, [Factsheet](#), 2 August 2022

Movement of Children and Youth, a government funded organisation chaired by President Putin.²²⁶

- Construction companies operating in the occupied regions of Ukraine.²²⁷

Financial restrictions

Initial sanctions measures targeted some of Russia's largest financial institutions to freeze assets and prevent them making clearing payments in US dollars and to prevent some of Russia's largest state-owned enterprises from raising capital on US markets. The US Treasury estimated this first set of announcements would target "nearly 80% of all banking assets in Russia".²²⁸

Further financial institutions have been targeted, including the Russian Central Bank and the Russian Direct Investment Fund, "a known slush fund for President Putin and his inner circle".²²⁹ The CEO, board members and officials of many major Russian banks have been sanctioned, including the Head of Sberbank, Herman Gref.²³⁰ Subsidiaries of sanctioned banks have also been targeted, including those in other countries.²³¹ In November 2024, the US sanctioned Gazprombank, Russia's largest remaining bank not already subject to sanctions and the main financial channel for Russian energy payments.²³²

As sanctions have evolved, attention has turned to smaller financial institutions, including banks, wealth management firms and third country actors linked to sanctions evasion. The US Treasury notes that "sanctioned actors have been known to turn to smaller banks as well as wealth-management firms in an attempt to evade sanctions as Russia seeks new ways to access the international financial system".²³³

Elvira Nabiullina, Governor of the Russian Central Bank has also been sanctioned, along with Olga Skorobogatova, First Deputy Governor of the Central Bank.²³⁴

²²⁶ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 April 2023 and [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024

²²⁷ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023

²²⁸ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2022

²²⁹ US Department of State, [Additional measures against the Russian financial system](#), 28 February 2022; US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 7 April 2022; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 15 December 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 December 2022 and [Press release](#), 20 July 2023

²³⁰ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 8 May 2022;

²³¹ In December 2022 the US Treasury sanctioned Embassy Development Limited, a subsidiary of VTB Bank based in the UK (US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 December 2022)

²³² US Department of State, [Press release](#), 21 November 2024 and "US imposes wide-ranging sanctions on Russian oil sector", The Financial Times, 10 January 2025

²³³ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; [Press release](#), 19 May 2023; [Press release](#), 14 September 2023; [Press release](#), 2 November 2023 and US Department of State, [Press release](#), 21 November 2024

²³⁴ The UK designated Nabiullina on the same day but did not designate Skorobogatova. The US has designated Skorobogatova following earlier guidance on Russian efforts to evade sanctions through its Mir payment system, for which she has oversight.

US investment in Russia's energy sector, either directly or indirectly through foreign companies was prohibited in March 2022,²³⁵ followed by an outright ban on new investment in Russia in April 2022.²³⁶ The US has also turned its attention to the facilitators of investment in Russia's energy and extractive industries.²³⁷

On 19 May 2023 the US implemented a reporting requirement on Russian sovereign assets, that will allow it to "fully map holdings of Russia's sovereign assets that will remain immobilized in G7 jurisdictions until Russia pays for the damage it has caused to Ukraine".²³⁸ The EU implemented similar reporting measures in February 2023,²³⁹ and the UK introduced legislation in December 2023 (see above).

In February 2024 the US took steps to further target Russia's core financial infrastructure by designating the state-owned operator of Russia's Mir National Payment Card System. The US had previously designated the Chief Executive of the National Payment Card System in September 2022. The Mir system was established by Russia in 2014 as an alternative to Visa and Mastercard and is increasingly viewed as a potential route to sanctions evasion as more countries accept it as a means of conducting transactions. In announcing the designation, the US Treasury said:

The Government of Russia's proliferation of Mir has permitted Russia to build out a financial infrastructure that enables Russian efforts to evade sanctions and reconstitute severed connections to the international financial system. The United States has repeatedly emphasized the risks of the Mir system to our partners around the globe.²⁴⁰

An additional nine Russian banks and five Russian venture capital funds financing Russia's development of advanced technologies were also designated.²⁴¹

In June 2024, additional measures targeting Russia's financial system were announced. In tandem with the UK, the US sanctioned the Moscow Stock Exchange (which subsequently suspended trading in dollars and euros), the National Clearing Centre and the National Settlement Depository.²⁴² It also moved to sanction Goznak, the Russian state-owned enterprise responsible for producing currency, bank notes and passports, along with its General Director. The company is also alleged to contribute to the production of counterfeit currency globally.²⁴³ Goznak has already been sanctioned by the UK (September 2022) and the EU (October 2022).

²³⁵ White House, [Fact sheet](#), 8 March 2022

²³⁶ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022

²³⁷ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 20 July 2023

²³⁸ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

²³⁹ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 25 February 2023

²⁴⁰ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 23 February 2024

²⁴¹ As above

²⁴² US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024

²⁴³ US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 12 June 2024

Targeting foreign financial support for Russia's 'war economy'

Russia has placed its economy on a war footing, where most sectors are reoriented to support military output. In response, the US has sought to increase the risk for foreign financial institutions that deal with Russian companies and individuals across any sector of the Russian economy. In December 2023, the ability of the US Treasury to sanction foreign financial institutions aiding Russia's military industrial base was expanded. That was taken a step further in June 2024, when the definition of Russia's military industrial base was expanded to include any sanctioned individual, company or entity. Foreign financial institutions now face the risk of secondary sanctions for conducting or facilitating transactions or providing any related service to anyone on the sanctions list, including Russian banks such as VTB and Sberbank and their subsidiaries. Announcing the change, the US Treasury said:

This expanded definition reflects Treasury's assessment that Russia has re-oriented its economy and marshalled all parts of its government toward supporting its reprehensible war effort. Foreign financial institutions face sanctions risk for continuing to facilitate transactions involving Russia's military-industrial base.²⁴⁴

Sanctioning of Russian firms/ research institutes/ international procurement and logistics networks

Several defence firms were already sanctioned prior to Russia's invasion.

Further Russian companies, including state-owned organisations, and in some cases their board members and family members, have been incrementally sanctioned across all strategic sectors of the Russian economy, including defence, aerospace, IT and technology, transport, construction, energy, mining, metals and critical minerals. Many have been designated for their role in enabling the Russian invasion, for their contribution to Russia's military capabilities or for their role in expanding Russia's energy production and export capabilities.²⁴⁵ Advanced technologies and critical components have been a particular focus and in November 2023 the US targeted Russia's

²⁴⁴ US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024

²⁴⁵ US Department of the Treasury, [Russia-related designations](#), 3 March 2022; US State Department, [Press release](#), 15 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Sanctions Notice](#), 31 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 7 April 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 8 May 2022; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 8 May 2022; US State Department, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022; US Department of State, [Press statement](#), 2 August 2022; US Department of State, [Fact sheet](#), 15 September 2022; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 15 December 2022 and US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 December 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 April 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 20 July 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023 and US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023 and [Press release](#), 2 November 2023 and US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023, [Press release](#), 12 December 2023; [Press release](#), 23 February 2024; US Treasury, [Press release](#), 23 February 2024; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 1 May 2024; [Press release](#), 12 June 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 30 October 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 10 January 2025 and [Fact Sheet](#), 15 January 2025

ability to export Liquefied Natural Gas (LNG) for the first time.²⁴⁶ Further LNG-related sanctions followed in February, May, June, August, September and October 2024 and January 2025.²⁴⁷ In January, the US and UK, also sanctioned Russian energy firm Gazprom for the first time.²⁴⁸

Defence procurement networks, including international suppliers, traders, companies based in third countries and transport networks have also been sanctioned. The US State Department said: “this action sends a clear message that international suppliers of sanctioned Russian entities and Russia’s defense sector run the risk of being sanctioned”.²⁴⁹ In September 2024 the US sanctioned a number of Russian shipping companies, and associated vessels, for their alleged involvement in the transport of Iranian UAV and missile-related equipment to Russia via the Caspian Sea.²⁵⁰

In February 2023 the US sanctioned three enterprises that develop and operated Russia’s nuclear weapons capabilities, as well as three Russian civil nuclear entities operating within the structure of Rosatom, the state-owned nuclear power company.²⁵¹ Individual designations linked to Rosatom were announced on 12 April 2023.²⁵² Further designations related to Russia’s nuclear weapons infrastructure were announced in February 2024,²⁵³ while further designations of subsidiaries of Rosatom were made in May, June, August and October 2024 and January 2025.²⁵⁴ In January 2025 the US also sanctioned Rosatom’s CEO and board of directors, to bring US policy into line with sanctions already imposed by the UK and Canada.²⁵⁵

To limit Russia’s future energy capabilities, the US has also announced sanctions on Russian research and educational institutes which specialise in

²⁴⁶ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023 and “US seeks to thwart Russia’s ambition to become major LNG exporter”, Financial Times, 12 November 2023.

²⁴⁷ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 1 May 2024; US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024 and US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024 and [Press release](#), 5 September 2024; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 30 October 2024 and [Fact Sheet](#), 10 January 2025

²⁴⁸ US Treasury, [Press release](#), 10 January 2025

²⁴⁹ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023; US State Department, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023; [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; US Department of Commerce, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 5 December 2023; State Department, [Press release](#), 12 December 2023 and [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024; US Treasury, [Press release](#), 23 February 2024

²⁵⁰ US Department of State, [Fact sheet](#), 10 September 2024. Iran’s support to Russia is examined in Library research briefing, [Sanctions against countries supporting Russia’s invasion of Ukraine](#)

²⁵¹ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023

²⁵² US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 April 2023

²⁵³ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024

²⁵⁴ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 1 May 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 12 June 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 30 October 2024 and [Fact Sheet](#), 15 January 2025

²⁵⁵ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 10 January 2025

the development of extractive technologies and are potential “training grounds” for future Russian energy specialists.²⁵⁶

Trade restrictions

In the immediate response to Russia’s invasion, the US imposed a ban on almost half of Russia’s high-tech imports to stop it developing its military capabilities.²⁵⁷

Further trade restrictions have included revoking [Russia’s Permanent Normal Trade Relations \(PNTR\) status](#), also referred to as Most Favoured Nation (MFN) status, allowing the US to increase, and impose new, tariffs on all Russian imports.²⁵⁸ Several export and import bans have also been announced:

Exports bans:

- Goods used to support Russian military capabilities, including dual-use items.
- Luxury goods.²⁵⁹
- Provision of accounting, management consultancy, architectural and engineering services.²⁶⁰
- Provision of certain software and IT services, including IT consultancy and design, IT support services and cloud-based services for enterprise management software and design and manufacturing software, bringing the US into line with EU and UK sanctions already in place.²⁶¹

Import bans:

- On 8 March 2022 President Biden signed an [Executive Order](#) banning the import of Russian crude oil, certain petroleum products, liquefied natural gas and coal to the United States.²⁶² In doing so, the US administration acknowledged that “not all of our Allies and partners are currently in a position to join us. But we are united with our Allies and partners in working together to reduce our collective dependence on Russian energy”.²⁶³ The US, as a member of the G7, has also implemented the price cap on oil imports, in coordination with the EU and a broader coalition of third nations (see above). To support compliance, since October 2023 the US has designated several entities transporting oil sold

²⁵⁶ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

²⁵⁷ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2022

²⁵⁸ White House, [Remarks by President Biden announcing actions to continue to hold Russia accountable](#), 11 March 2022. That measure also applies to Belarus. Also see US State Department, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022 and Office of the United States Trade Representative, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023

²⁵⁹ US Department of the Treasury, [Executive Order on Prohibiting Certain Imports](#), 11 March 2022

²⁶⁰ International Trade Administration, [Professional Services News](#), 8 May 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023

²⁶¹ US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024

²⁶² White House, [Background press call](#), 8 March 2022

²⁶³ White House, [Fact sheet](#), 8 March 2022

above the agreed price cap and is increasingly targeting vessels in Russia's 'shadow fleet'.²⁶⁴

- In March 2022 a ban on Russian diamonds, vodka and seafood was implemented.²⁶⁵ The UK announced a ban on Russian diamonds on 18 May 2023 (see above), followed by the EU in December 2023 (see below). Up until this point Russia's billion-dollar diamond trade had been subject to limited sanctions measures in the UK and EU.²⁶⁶ In December 2023, the US also moved to impose restrictions on the import of products that have been processed or transformed in third countries, including diamonds and seafood.²⁶⁷
- Gold originating in Russia.²⁶⁸ In June 2024 the US also designated various international networks laundering gold for a designated Russian gold producer.²⁶⁹
- Aluminium, copper and nickel of Russian origin produced on or after 13 April 2024. The UK announced an import ban on these metals in May 2023 and brought it into effect in December 2023 (see above). Alongside the London Metal Exchange, the Chicago Mercantile Exchange will no longer trade in new shipments of these metals.²⁷⁰
- Uranium.²⁷¹ To date, the UK and the EU have not imposed a ban on Russian uranium imports. UK and EU sanctions related to the civil nuclear sector have, so far, been limited to various subsidiary companies and individuals linked to Rosatom, Russia's State Atomic Energy Corporation.

Propagandists and the spread of disinformation

Like allies, the US has imposed sanctions on those individuals and organisations that have spread "false narratives" about the conflict in Ukraine. Among them are Russian state-owned or pro-Kremlin media organisations, propagandists, government spokespeople and Russian nationals involved in the suppression of dissent, both at home and abroad.²⁷²

In September 2024 the US issued an alert over the "covert global activities" of RT (formerly Russia Today). The State Department said that the organisation had moved beyond "being simply a media outlet" and was engaged in cyber and information operations, covert influence and military procurement

²⁶⁴ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 October 2023; [Press release](#), 16 November 2023; [Press release](#), 1 December 2023; [Press release](#), 20 December 2023; [Press release](#), 18 January 2024; [Press release](#), 8 February 2024; [Press release](#), 23 February 2024 and US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024

²⁶⁵ US Department of the Treasury, [Executive Order on Prohibiting Certain Imports](#), 11 March 2022

²⁶⁶ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 6 March 2023

²⁶⁷ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 22 December 2023

²⁶⁸ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022

²⁶⁹ US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024

²⁷⁰ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 April 2024

²⁷¹ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 14 May 2024

²⁷² US Department of the Treasury, [Russia-related designations](#), 3 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 8 May 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 June 2022; US State Department, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022; US State Department, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023; [Press release](#), 20 March 2024 and US Treasury, [Press release](#), 20 March 2024

through an online crowdfunding platform, specifically for Russia's operations in Ukraine. The US also announced sanctions on several entities and individuals linked to RT, including the Editor-in-Chief Margarita Simonyan, albeit for attempts to interfere in the forthcoming US and Moldovan presidential elections and not specifically linked to the conflict in Ukraine. The US urged partners and allies "to recognise the gravity of this threat and to treat's RT's covert operations seriously".²⁷³

Sanctions evasion

As sanctions have evolved the US has taken steps, in concert with allies, to prevent companies from evading sanctions and procuring "critical Western technology" on behalf of Russia. As outlined above, that list of items has evolved into what is termed the [Common High Priority List](#), developed alongside the EU, UK and Japan).²⁷⁴ It is also working to prevent circumvention by designated Russian oligarchs and has banned the provision of services used by the Russian government and elites to evade sanctions, including accounting, management consulting, and trust and corporate formation services.²⁷⁵ As a result of these efforts, the US has sanctioned an increasing number of companies and entities in third countries, and often on a much broader scale than the EU and the UK.

Since March 2022, the US has announced sanctions on companies, port operators, shipping companies, airlines, defence procurement networks, arms dealers, and associated individuals alleged to be procuring foreign items for Russia's defence industry, for the Russian government, including the Russian Intelligence Services, and on behalf of the Wagner Group or for facilitating Russia's energy exports and evasion of the oil price cap.²⁷⁶ Several companies in the UK, the British Virgin Islands, Germany, Turkey, Serbia, UAE,

²⁷³ US Department of State, [Press release](#), 13 September 2024 and US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 4 September 2024

²⁷⁴ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 31 March 2022

²⁷⁵ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 8 May 2022 and US Department of State, [Press release](#), 25 March 2024

²⁷⁶ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 31 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 28 June 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 2 August 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 October 2022; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 14 November 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 1 February 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 24 February 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 30 March 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 April 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 19 May 2023; [Press release](#), 20 July 2023; [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; US Department of Commerce, [Press release](#), 2 November 2023; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 5 December 2023; State Department, [Press release](#), 12 December 2023; [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 1 May 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 12 June 2024; US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024 and US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024; Treasury, [Press release](#), 23 August 2024; US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 30 October 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 10 January 2025 and [Fact Sheet](#), 15 January 2025

Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Hong Kong and China, among others, have been identified for their involvement in sanctions evading procurement activities.²⁷⁷

The US has targeted Russian-based cybercrime networks, money launderers, virtual currency exchanges and virtual currency mining companies that potentially allow for sanctions evasion.²⁷⁸

The US has also designated banks and global financial networks of entities and individuals involved in sanctions evasion on behalf of, or led by, Russian oligarchs.²⁷⁹ Companies in the British Virgin Islands have been implicated.²⁸⁰ The US Department of Justice charged Russian oligarch Konstantin Malofeyev for violating US sanctions on 6 April 2022.²⁸¹ Russian billionaire, Oleg Deripaska was indicted for sanctions evasion in September 2022.²⁸²

On 15 September 2022, the US Treasury also designated several individuals associated with institutions that play a role in Russia's financial market infrastructure. These included the Chief Executive of the National Card Payment System, an entity (owned by Russia's Central Bank) that operates the country's Mir payment system.²⁸³ On 20 September 2022, two of Turkey's largest private banks suspended their acceptance of transactions through the Mir system for fear of secondary US sanctions.²⁸⁴ That move was followed by all of Turkey's state-owned banks on 29 September.²⁸⁵ In early October 2022, Egypt's Central Bank also shelved plans to introduce the Mir payment system.²⁸⁶

²⁷⁷ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 31 March 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 30 September 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 26 January 2023 and [Press release](#), 12 April 2023; US State Department, [Press release](#), 14 September 2023; [Fact Sheet](#), 23 February 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 1 May 2024; [Fact Sheet](#), 12 June 2024; US Treasury, [Press release](#), 12 June 2024; US State Department, [Fact Sheet](#), 23 August 2024; US Treasury, [Press release](#), 17 October 2024; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 30 October 2024

²⁷⁸ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 5 April 2022; [Press release](#), 20 April 2022; [Press release](#), 2 November 2023 and [Press release](#), 25 March 2024

²⁷⁹ US Department of Justice, [Press release](#), 6 April 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 20 April 2022; Department of State, [Press release](#), 14 November 2022; US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 14 November 2022 and US Department of State, [Press release](#), 12 April 2023; US Department of State, [Press release](#), 25 March 2024; [Press release](#), 13 June 2024 and Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 23 August 2024

²⁸⁰ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 14 November 2022

²⁸¹ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 5 April 2022. Malofeyev was designated by the US in 2014.

²⁸² US Attorney's Office, [Press release](#), 29 September 2022

²⁸³ US Department of the Treasury, [Press release](#), 15 September 2022

²⁸⁴ ["Major Turkish banks halt use of Russia's Mir payment system"](#), The Moscow Times, 20 September 2022

²⁸⁵ ["Turkey's state banks suspend use of Russian Mir payment system"](#), Reuters, 29 September 2022

²⁸⁶ ["Egypt freezes Russian Mir payments to avoid US sanctions"](#), AL Monitor, 8 October 2022

7 Relevant links

- US Department of the Treasury, [Press releases](#)
- US Department of State, [Sanctions press releases](#)
- US Department of the Treasury, [Ukraine/Russia related sanctions](#)
- US State Department, [Holding Russia and Belarus to account: Sanctions](#)
- US State Department, [Ukraine and Russia sanctions](#)
- US Department of the Treasury, [Remarks on the price cap on Russian oil](#), 4 April 2024
- US Department of the Treasury, [Fact Sheet: Disrupting and degrading - one year of US sanctions on Russia and its enablers](#), February 2023
- A list of US sanctioned individuals is available from the [US Treasury](#)

3.2

European Union

Prior to Russia's invasion of Ukraine, EU restrictive measures relating to the sovereignty and territorial integrity of Ukraine already applied to 193 individuals and 48 entities.²⁸⁷

Initial sanctions

In response to Russia's recognition of the Donetsk People's Republic (DPR) and the Luhansk People's Republic (LPR), on 22 February 2022 EU Foreign Ministers agreed a new package of sanctions.

[351 members of the Russia Duma](#) who voted for recognition were listed, restrictions were placed on trade with the DPR and LPR, financial institutions and defence companies were targeted, and measures were taken to prevent the Russian government and state-owned organisations from accessing European capital and finance markets and services.²⁸⁸ EU High Representative, Josep Borrell, confirmed the EU would also "raise the level of sanctions substantially, according with Russian behaviour".²⁸⁹

²⁸⁷ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 21 February 2022

²⁸⁸ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 22 February 2022

²⁸⁹ EU External Action Service, [Press remarks by High Representative Josep Borrell](#), 22 February 2022

Further rounds of sanctions

Following the invasion of Ukraine on 24 February 2022, the EU, in concert with allies, has incrementally imposed further sanctions measures.²⁹⁰

According to the European Commission, sanctions are designed to:

- Reduce the Kremlin's ability to finance the war
- Impose clear economic and political costs on Russia's political elite
- Diminish Russia's economic base.²⁹¹

At the time of writing, almost 2,400 individuals and entities are subject to EU sanctions because their actions have undermined Ukraine's territorial integrity, sovereignty and independence or they are engaged in sanctions circumvention.

Council of the European Union, [EU restrictive measures against Russia over Ukraine](#)

In early March 2022, the European Commission established a Freeze and Seize Task Force, to ensure EU-level coordination to implement sanctions against listed Russian and Belarussian oligarchs. That task force also works alongside the Russian Elites, Proxies and Oligarchs (REPO) Task Force established by the US, EU, UK and other allies (see below).²⁹²

As sanctions have evolved there has been an increasing focus on closing loopholes in the sanctions framework to prevent circumvention. The EU has broadened the criteria on which sanctions designations can be based, to include those individuals or entities that facilitate the evasion of EU sanctions.²⁹³ The fifteenth, and latest, package of sanctions was adopted on 16 December 2024. That package of measures focused on the circumvention of sanctions, targeting Russia's shadow fleet and those companies supporting Russia's military industrial complex, particularly in third countries. For the first time, the EU imposed sanctions on Chinese firms directly providing military assistance to Russia.²⁹⁴

The following information summarises the sanctions measures which the EU has collectively imposed in relation to the conflict in Ukraine since February 2022. Sanctions have also been adopted in relation to [human rights violations in Russia](#) and its increasing [use of hybrid activities to undermine the EU and its member states](#), although neither are the focus of this briefing.

All references and footnotes are to the EU's guide to sanctions and explainers, which are available at:

- [Sanctions adopted following Russia's military aggression against Ukraine](#)
- [EU sanctions against Russia explained - Consilium \(europa.eu\)](#)
- [EU sanctions against Russia](#)

²⁹⁰ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 25 February 2022; [Press release](#), 28 February 2022; [Press release](#), 9 March 2022; [Press release](#), 8 April 2022; [Press release](#), 3 June 2022; [Press release](#), 21 July 2022; [Press release](#), 6 October 2022; [Press release](#), 16 December 2022; [Press release](#), 25 February 2023; [Press release](#), 23 June 2023; [Press release](#), 18 December 2023; [Press release](#), 23 February 2024 and [Press release](#), 24 June 2024

²⁹¹ European Commission, [EU sanctions against Russia following the invasion of Ukraine](#) (accessed 26 September 2024)

²⁹² European Commission, [Press release](#), 17 March 2022

²⁹³ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 16 December 2022

²⁹⁴ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 16 December 2024

The full list of designated individuals and entities is available in the [EU's Official Journal](#) or in the European Commission's [Financial Sanctions Files](#) (sign up required).

EU leaders have also placed sanctions on Belarus for its role in facilitating Russian military aggression in Ukraine, on Iran in relation to the manufacture and supply of drones and ballistic missiles to Russia and on North Korea for supplying weapons and troops to Russia. These are examined in Library research briefing: [Sanctions against countries supporting Russia's invasion of Ukraine](#).

Detail of the agreement reached by EU member states in May 2024 on the use of profits from sanctioned Russian assets to provide military assistance to Ukraine, and support its reconstruction, is examined in Library research briefing: [Sanctions, international law and seizing Russian assets](#).

Designation of the Russian leadership

President Putin and Russian Foreign Minister Sergey Lavrov [have been placed on the sanctions list](#), along with the members of Russia's National Security Council, government ministers, and the members of the Russian Parliament not previously designated.

Regional Governors, members of the State and provincial Dumas, the Mayor of Moscow and other political officials have subsequently been sanctioned.

Facilitators of Russian actions in Ukraine

Individuals and organisations who have facilitated the Russian invasion, supported Russia's actions and enabled the Russian annexation of Donetsk, Luhansk, Kherson and Zaporizhzhia Oblasts in October 2022, have been sanctioned.

They include:

- High-ranking military leaders responsible for Russian tactics in Ukraine, and those military personnel accused of committing atrocities in Ukraine.
- Individuals and organisations that played a role in the organisation of the independence referendums and Russian-installed officials in the annexed regions. Further designations have followed on from the holding of "elections" in the annexed regions in September 2023.²⁹⁵
- Russian officials, members of the judiciary, local politicians, and those involved in the deportation and forced adoption of Ukrainian children to Russia and the forced re-education of children in annexed regions.
- Individuals responsible for looting objects of cultural heritage and engaging in religious persecution.

²⁹⁵ This measure was introduced in the 12th package of sanctions approved in December 2023.

- Individuals involved in Russian conscription and those associated with recruiting for, or fighting with, the Wagner Group, including in Syria. The group itself had already been sanctioned by the EU in December 2021.²⁹⁶
- Companies and individuals implicated in the theft of Ukrainian grain harvests.

In August 2022, the EU also added former Ukrainian President Viktor Yanukovych and his son, Olexsandr, to the sanctions list for their role in undermining Ukraine's territorial integrity and stability. Olexsandr Yanukovych is also accused of conducting transactions with separatist groups in the Donbas.²⁹⁷

Oligarchs and Putin's inner circle

In concert with allies, the EU has targeted Russia's oligarchs and other prominent Russian businesspeople who have benefitted from their association with the Kremlin. To prevent the circumvention of sanctions, their network of enablers and family members have increasingly been targeted, along with the members of Putin's inner circle. Among them are member of President Putin's immediate family, including his daughters and alleged partner, Alina Kabaeva, and the Nightwolves Motorcycle Club, which has close ties to President Putin.

Restrictions in the financial sector

Access to EU financial markets has been restricted and a full asset freeze has been imposed on several Russian banks and investment funds, including the Russian Central Bank, Sberbank (Russia's largest bank) and the Russian Direct Investment Fund. Several Russian banks, including Sberbank, have also been expelled from the SWIFT system (see above).

Financial restrictions apply to "crypto assets" and the sale, supply, transfer or export of banknotes in any official currency of the EU Member States is prohibited. Russian individuals are also restricted from depositing money in EU banks over a certain value.

The EU has also imposed a general ban on the participation of Russian companies in public procurement in EU member states and the exclusion of all financial support to Russian public bodies by the European Investment Bank and the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development. As part of wider measures targeting Russia's energy sector (see below), in June 2024 the EU also imposed a ban on new financial investment in Russian LNG (liquefied natural gas) infrastructure projects.²⁹⁸

The EU has also introduced new reporting obligations on the European Commission and EU Member States on the frozen reserves and assets of the Russian Central Bank and in February 2024 adopted a decision that will allow

²⁹⁶ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 13 December 2021

²⁹⁷ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 4 August 2022

²⁹⁸ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 24 June 2024

the extraordinary revenue generated from those immobilised assets to be set aside.²⁹⁹ In May 2024 the EU reached an agreement on the use of windfall profits from sanctioned Russian assets to support Ukraine’s “self-defence and reconstruction”.³⁰⁰ This agreement is examined in greater detail in Library research briefing: [Sanctions, international law and seizing Russian assets](#).

In the 14th package of sanctions (June 2024), EU entities are also prohibited from connecting to, and using, Russia’s System for Transfer of Financial Messages (SPFS), developed by Russia’s Central Bank as an alternative to the SWIFT system (see above). EU operators are barred from conducting transactions with specifically identified entities using SPFS outside of Russia.³⁰¹

In line with recent measures introduced in the US aimed at prohibiting financial support for Russia’s military industrial base (see above), EU operators are also banned from conducting transactions with financial institutions and crypto assets providers outside of the EU where these entities are facilitating support for Russia’s defence industrial base.³⁰²

Trade sanctions

At the outset of the conflict the EU extended its sanction regime to the non-Government controlled regions of the Donetsk People’s Republic and the Luhansk People’s Republic (see above). That geographical scope has since been extended to include the non-Government controlled areas within Kherson and Zaporizhzhia Oblasts. Exemptions could be made with respect to ensuring the security and safety of the Zaporizhzhia nuclear power plant.³⁰³

The EU has introduced several import and export bans on specific goods and technologies.

Import bans:

- Coal and other solid fossil fuels, if they originate in Russia or are exported from Russia.
- Wood, cement, fertilisers, seafood and liquor. The EU has made clear that its sanctions do not affect the sale of fertilisers by Russia to third countries (see below)
- Russian crude-oil and certain] petroleum products.³⁰⁴ The EU also supports the imposition of a price cap on Russian oil imports (see

²⁹⁹ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 12 February 2024

³⁰⁰ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 21 May 2024

³⁰¹ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 24 June 2024

³⁰² As above

³⁰³ European Commission, [Frequently asked questions](#), 6 October 2022

³⁰⁴ A temporary exception is provided for imports of crude oil by pipeline for those landlocked countries, including Hungary, which rely on Russian supplies and have no viable alternative options. Bulgaria and Croatia will also benefit from a temporary derogation concerning the import of Russian seaborne crude oil and vacuum gas oil (Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 3 June 2022).

above).³⁰⁵ In December 2023 the EU agreed on the prohibition of liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) imports (subject to a 12-month transitional period). In June 2024 the EU imposed sanctions, for the first time, on Russia's [liquefied natural gas \(LNG\)](#) exports, albeit limited to a prohibition on transshipment services within EU territory for Russian LNG destined for re-export to third countries.³⁰⁶ These sanctions do not impact the import of LNG to EU countries, some of whom, including Hungary, continue to rely heavily on Russian gas imports.³⁰⁷ The EU is [committed to reducing its reliance on Russian energy by 2030](#).

- The purchase, import, or transfer to third countries of gold originating in Russia. The prohibition will also extend to jewellery.
- Steel products that originate in, or have been exported from, Russia.
- Wood pulp and paper, cigarettes, plastics, cosmetics, vehicles, textiles, footwear, leather, ceramics and certain items relating to the jewellery industry such as precious stones and metals.
- Asphalt and synthetic rubber.
- In December 2023 the EU agreed a ban on Russian diamond and diamond jewellery imports, purchases and transfers which came into force on 1 January 2024. A phased ban on the import of Russian-origin diamonds from third countries will begin in March 2024 (through to September 2024), in line with measures introduced by the G7 (see US and UK above).³⁰⁸
- Certain metals, including Russian-origin aluminium wires, foils, tubes and pipes. A broader ban on imports of Russian metals, specifically aluminium, has been met with opposition from a number of EU countries including Italy and Germany.³⁰⁹
- Helium.

In June 2024 the EU also announced a ban on the purchase, import, transfer or export of goods or property of Ukrainian cultural heritage, alongside any goods of archaeological, historical, cultural, rare scientific or religious importance where there are grounds to believe they have been unlawfully removed from Ukraine.

Export bans:

- Specific goods and technologies related to the oil refining sector, the aviation and space industry, including aircraft engines and their parts. This will effectively prohibit the export of drone engines to Russia and any third countries, such as Iran, that could supply drones to Russia.

³⁰⁵ The EU introduced the necessary legislation to implement those price cap measures on 6 October 2022 (Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 6 October 2022)

³⁰⁶ The import and then re-sale of Russian LNG to third countries, including ship-to-ship and ship-to-shore transfers and reloading operations.

³⁰⁷ [“Hungary’s new gas deal fuels Russia fears”](#), Politico, 2 April 2024 and [“The Kremlin’s grip: How Russia fossil fuels shape Hungary’s fate”](#), Visegrad Insight, 30 May 2024

³⁰⁸ This measure was introduced in the 12th package of sanctions approved in December 2023.

³⁰⁹ [“EU faces pressure to sanctions Russian aluminium”](#), Politico, 5 February 2024. A UK ban on the import of Russian-origin metals, including aluminium, came into force in December 2023 (see Section 2.3 above).

- Dual-use goods and technologies related to the defence and security sector, including semi-conductors and their composite materials, high-end electronics, drones and associated software, components used in weapon systems such as helicopters and missiles, rare earth minerals and their compounds, precursors to energetic materials and chemical weapons, encryption software, key chemicals, nerve agents, night vision, thermal cameras and radio navigation equipment, electronics and IT components and additional goods that can be used for capital punishment, torture or cruel and degrading treatment. Restrictions have also been imposed on the provision of related services.
- Maritime navigation goods and radio communication technology
- Equipment, technology and services for the energy sector.
- Iron and steel
- Luxury goods
- Jet fuel
- Quantum computers and associated technologies/ software.
- Sensitive machinery and transportation equipment, including their components.
- The provision of accounting, public relations, consultancy, cloud services, architectural and engineering services, IT consultancy and legal advisory services.
- Critical technology and industrial goods, including electronics, specialised vehicles, all-terrain vehicles, spare parts for trucks and jet engines and those goods used in the construction sector which could be diverted to the military.

Preventing circumvention

In a speech on 9 May 2023 Commission President Ursula von der Leyen referred to “a growth of highly unusual trade flows between the European Union and certain third countries”, with goods then ending up in Russia.³¹⁰ Those countries are thought to include China, United Arab Emirates, Turkey, and some Caucasus and Central Asian states.³¹¹

After almost six weeks of discussions, on 23 June 2023 the EU Member States adopted an eleventh package of sanctions, which focused primarily on addressing this issue of circumvention in, and by, third countries.³¹² Among the measures announced were:

³¹⁰ European Commission, [Press statement by President von der Leyen with Ukrainian President Zelenskyy](#), 9 May 2023

³¹¹ “[EU targets evasion in proposed new round of Russia sanctions](#)”, Le Monde, 8 May 2023 and European Policy Centre, [11th package of EU sanctions: focusing on circumvention](#), 16 May 2023. See also EU External Action Service, [Some clarifications on the circumvention of EU sanctions against Russia](#), 19 May 2023

³¹² The eleventh package of sanctions was proposed on 8 May 2023 (European Commission, [Press statement by President von der Leyen with Ukrainian President Zelenskyy](#), 9 May 2023. See also EU External Action Service, [Some clarifications on the circumvention of EU sanctions against Russia](#), 19 May 2023)

- **Transit ban** - More goods and technology which could be used for the development of Russia's defence, security, aviation and space sectors, or may contribute to its military/ technological capabilities including jet fuel and fuel additives, will be prohibited from transiting the territory of Russia on the way from the EU to third countries. That measure was strengthened in December 2023 with the inclusion of those goods and technologies used on the battlefield, and in February 2024 for those goods used in the development and manufacture of UAV.
- **Circumvention tool** – The EU will strengthen bilateral and multilateral cooperation with third countries, and provide technical assistance, to monitor the end-use of exports to those countries. Where cooperation proves not to be working, the EU will be able to impose “appropriate individual measures” to address the involvement of third countries in circumvention. Where sanctions evasion remains “substantial and systemic”, and as a measure of last resort, the EU may impose a ban on the sale, supply, transfer or export of those goods.
- **Sanctions designations** - A ban on entities in Russia and third countries that are intentionally circumventing sanctions (see above).³¹³

In explaining these new measures, the European Commission said; “This does not mean the EU is imposing sanctions against third countries or their governments. We are simply trying to make sure that sanctioned EU goods do not end up in Russia”.³¹⁴

Several new measures were subsequently introduced in December 2023, including a prohibition on the transit through Russia, to third countries, of EU exported dual-use items and goods on the Common High Priority List, and a prohibition on the sale, transfer or licensing of intellectual property rights connected with restricted goods and technologies.³¹⁵ EU exporters will also be required to contractually prohibit third party re-exportation to Russia of any sensitive goods and technology (except for partner countries).³¹⁶

As outlined below (see [Russian aircraft, shipping and road transport](#)), the EU has also been targeting Russia's shadow fleet. This is used to transport Russian oil and oil products around the globe in contravention of the Oil Price Cap. The EU has also increasingly been targeting companies in third countries that are supporting Russia's military base, including in China. In December 2024, the EU imposed, for the first time, sanctions on several Chinese companies that are directly supporting Russian drone production as opposed to assistance through the export of dual-use goods and technologies.³¹⁷

³¹³ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 23 June 2023 and Official Journal of the European Union, [L159 I, Vol.66, 23 June 2023](#) (PDF)

³¹⁴ European Commission, [Questions and answers on the 11th package of restrictive measures against Russia](#), 23 June 2023

³¹⁵ Those goods and technologies which could be incorporated into Russian systems for use on the battlefield. This measure was introduced in December 2023.

³¹⁶ This latter measure was introduced in the 12th package of sanctions approved in December 2023.

³¹⁷ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 16 December 2024

Ending Russia's Most Favoured Nation (MFN) trading status

On 15 March 2022, the European Commission announced that the EU, alongside G7 nations and other “like minded partners”, including Australia, Albania, Iceland, South Korea, Moldova, Montenegro, New Zealand, North Macedonia and Norway will end Russia's MFN status “as of today”.³¹⁸

The EU said that such actions were “justified under the security exemptions of the WTO agreement”.³¹⁹

Russian imports that are not subject to an outright ban are now subject to additional tariffs.

Sanctioned companies

Companies across all strategic sectors of the Russian economy, including defence, transport, manufacturing and energy have been sanctioned. Assets have been frozen, and companies are prevented from accessing EU capital markets. The senior management and management boards of several companies, particularly in the defence sector, have also been individually sanctioned.

All transactions with certain state-owned enterprises have been prohibited, along with any new investments in the Russian energy sector and mining sector.

Sanctions have been put in place on all companies whose products or technology, including dual-use technologies, have played a role in the invasion of Ukraine.

The EU has also announced a ban on EU nationals holding any post on the governing body of a Russian state-owned or controlled organisation or body.

To avoid the circumvention of sanctions, some Russian-controlled entities in Crimea and Sevastopol have also been designated.

Companies in third countries which are directly supporting Russia's military and industrial complex, or are helping Russia evade sanctions primarily through the export of dual-use items have also been sanctioned. This includes entities in Iran, China, Uzbekistan, United Arab Emirates, Syria, Armenia, India, Sri Lanka, Serbia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Thailand and Turkey.³²⁰

Visas and positions of influence

Visa free travel for Russia diplomats has been stopped and Russian officials and businesspeople will no longer benefit from visa facilitation provisions, allowing privileged access to the EU.

³¹⁸ European Commission, [Statement by Executive Vice President Dombrovskis](#), 15 March 2022

³¹⁹ European Commission, [Statement by Executive Vice President Dombrovskis](#), 15 March 2022

³²⁰ See [EU regulation 2024/745 amending Annex IV of Regulation 833/2014](#) (PDF), 23 February 2024 and Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 24 June 2024

On 9 September 2022 the EU Council of Ministers also agreed to suspend the visa facilitation agreement between the EU and Russia. All Russian citizens will now be subject to an increase in visa application fees, will be required to present additional documentary evidence and will be subject to more restrictive rules on the issuance of multiple entry visas.

Russian nationals are also restricted from holding any position on the governing bodies of EU critical infrastructures and entities.

Russian aircraft, shipping and road transport

All Russian aircraft have been [banned from EU airspace](#), including those of Russian oligarchs. In June 2024 the flight ban was also extended to any aircraft being used for a non-scheduled flight by any Russian national or entity. Operators will also be obliged to provide any information requested by competent national authorities within the EU member states about any non-scheduled flights, including ownership of the aircraft and passengers.

Vessels registered under the flag of Russia are prevented from accessing EU ports. Some exemptions exist for vessels carrying agricultural and food products, humanitarian aid and energy products.

Any vessel engaging in ship-to-ship transfers and suspected to either be in breach of the EU ban on importing seaborne Russian crude oil or is transporting Russian crude oil or petroleum products purchased above the G7 coalition price cap (see [Imposition of an Oil Price Cap and targeting Russia's "shadow fleet"](#)), is also prevented from accessing EU ports and locks. The same prohibition will apply to any vessels that switch off or disable their navigation systems while suspected of transporting Russian crude oil or petroleum products.

As part of measures announced in June 2024 targeting the export of Russian LNG (see above), Sovcomflot, Russia's largest shipping company specialising in the transportation of LNG, crude oil and petroleum products, along with its CEO, were designated. The EU also sanctioned 27 specific vessels for their involvement in the transport of military equipment to Russia, the shipping of stolen Ukrainian grain, transshipments of LNG, or are being used as part of Russia's shadow fleet to circumvent the oil price cap. Those vessels are now subject to an EU port access ban and a ban on the provision of services. Further sanctions targeting Russia's shadow fleet and vessels involved in the transport of Russian military equipment and stolen Ukrainian grain, were announced in December 2024.³²¹

The EU has also imposed a ban on any Russian or Belarusian road transport, thereby preventing the transportation of Russian goods by road within the EU. This includes trailers and semi-trailers registered in Russia and transported by trucks registered outside of Russia. That prohibition was expanded in June

³²¹ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 16 December 2024

2024 to include the transport of goods by EU operators that are owned 25% or more by a Russian national.

Exemptions have been made for certain items, such as humanitarian aid, pharmaceutical and medical products.

Targeting disinformation

Individuals and organisations involved in the dissemination of propaganda and disinformation have been sanctioned.

Various state-owned media, including RT, Ria Novosti, Sputnik and Rossiya 24 have been banned from broadcasting in the EU, and their management sanctioned. Broadcasting outlets, social media platforms, media personalities and lobbyists supporting the war have also been sanctioned, along with Dmitry Peskov, President Putin's Press Secretary and Maria Zakharova, spokesperson for the Russian Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

The EU has also banned the provision of EU advertising, market research and public opinion polling services to Russia, in addition to product testing and technical inspection services.³²²

In June 2024 the EU announced that political parties and foundations, non-governmental organisations, including think tanks, and media providers in the EU will no longer be allowed to accept funding from the Russian state or its proxies.³²³

In October 2024, the EU also established [a new sanctions framework to address Russia's destabilising actions abroad](#), including the use of disinformation and interference to undermine the EU and its member states. The first sanctions under that new framework were announced in December 2024 and included various actors spreading disinformation in support of Russia's war in Ukraine.³²⁴

Exemptions - Energy and food security

To avoid any "potential negative consequences for food and energy security around the world" the EU has extended sanctions exemptions to agricultural products from certain state-owned Russian entities and the transport of oil from Russia to third countries.³²⁵

The EU also clarified that none of the measures it has adopted so far target the trade in agricultural and food products, including wheat and fertilisers, between third countries and Russia.

However, to combat food insecurity and avoid disruption in payments for agricultural products, in its ninth package of sanctions in October 2022 the EU

³²² EU Council of Ministers, [Press release](#), 16 December 2022

³²³ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 24 June 2024

³²⁴ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 16 December 2024

³²⁵ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 21 July 2022

announced a derogation allowing for the unfreezing of assets, and to make funds and economic resources available to, certain sanctioned individuals who held a significant role in the international trade in food and agricultural products prior to their listing.³²⁶

Military assistance

In February 2022, the EU announced that, for the first time in its history, it would [finance the purchase and delivery of lethal military equipment](#) to a third country.³²⁷

The provision of EU military assistance to Ukraine is examined in greater detail in House of Commons Library, [Military assistance to Ukraine since the Russian invasion \(February 2022 to January 2025\)](#).

8 Relevant links

- European Commission, [EU sanctions against Russia following the invasion of Ukraine](#)
- European Commission, [Frequently asked questions concerning sanctions](#)
- Council of the European Union, [EU sanctions against Russia](#)
- Council of the European Union, [EU sanctions against Russia explained](#)
- The full list of designated individuals and entities is available in the [EU's Official Journal](#) or in the European Commission's [Financial Sanctions Files](#) (sign up required).

3.3 Other countries

Sanctions have been supported around the globe by numerous Western allies and partners.

Other countries of the G7

At the outset of the current crisis, the countries of the G7 made clear they would act collectively on the imposition of sanctions against Russia.³²⁸

³²⁶ EU Council of Ministers, [Press release](#), 16 December 2022

³²⁷ Council of the European Union, [Press release](#), 28 February 2022.

³²⁸ German Federal Foreign Office, [G7 Foreign Minister's statement on Russia and Ukraine](#), 19 February 2022

At the time of writing, 1,509 individuals and 646 entities are subject to Canadian sanctions under its [Special Economic Measures \(Russia\) Regulations](#).

Canada

In concert with the EU, US and UK, Canada has had sanctions in place against Russia since 2014. Additional sanctions measures have also been introduced for human rights violations by the Russian state.

In response to Russia's invasion of Ukraine, further rolling measures have been introduced by the Canadian government since 24 February 2022:³²⁹

Sanctioned Individuals

- Members of the Russian Duma and the Federation Council.
- Members of Russia's Security Council, including President Putin, Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov and Defence Minister Sergei Shoigu and other government ministers and officials (former and current).
- Oligarchs, close associates of the regime and family members.
- Individuals who have supported or facilitated Russian actions in Ukraine, including Russian-installed officials, facilitators of the 2022 referendums and subsequent annexation of Ukrainian territory, those involved in the "illegal elections" held in the annexed regions in September 2023, military officials and those accused of war crimes. Canada sanctioned the Wagner Group, and its former leader Yevgeny Prigozhin, in February 2022.³³⁰
- Entities and individuals deemed responsible for spreading disinformation and propaganda.
- Individuals and entities involved in human rights violations, including the forcible deportation of Ukrainian children to Russia.
- Several federal institutions, including both Houses of the Russian Parliament, United Russia (President Putin's political party), the General Staff of the Armed Forces and the Federal Security Bureau (FSB).
- Individuals and entities connected to the theft, damage or destruction of Ukrainian cultural property in Russian-occupied areas of Ukraine and those complicit in Russia's efforts to "Russify" Ukrainian culture.

Financial and trade restrictions

- Sanctions against Russian financial institutions, including the Russian Central Bank, the Russian Ministry of Finance and the National Wealth Fund, and prohibitions on Russian sovereign debt.
- Sanctions against companies and key officials across all strategic sectors of the Russian economy, including defence, aerospace, nuclear, maritime, transport, telecommunications and energy.
- A ban on trade with annexed regions of Ukraine.
- On 3 March 2022 Canada also stripped Russia, and Belarus, of their status as preferential trading partners. A 35% tariff is now applied to all Russian and Belarusian imports.³³¹ The remaining G7 nations, along with the EU and other partners announced this step on 11 March.

³²⁹ Government of Canada, [Sanctions – Russian invasion of Ukraine](#) (accessed 18 December 2023)

³³⁰ Government of Canada, [Sanctions – Russian invasion of Ukraine](#) (accessed 18 December 2023)

³³¹ Department of Finance Canada, [News release](#), 3 March 2022

- Restrictions on exports and imports such as iron, steel, aluminium, gold, luxury goods, diamonds and oil.³³² As a G7 country Canada also supports the implementation of a price cap on imports of Russian crude oil to third countries.³³³
- Closing Canadian airspace and territorial waters to all Russian-owned, chartered, or operated aircraft and ships.³³⁴

Canadian sanctions have also been imposed against Belarus for its role in the Russian invasion of Ukraine and to close potential sanctions evasion loopholes, against several Iranian companies and individuals for the provision of UAV and ballistic missiles to Russia, and those involved in the transfer of weapons from North Korea to Russia.³³⁵

9 Useful links

- Government of Canada, [Sanctions – Russian invasion of Ukraine](#)
- Government of Canada, [Consolidated Canadian autonomous sanctions list](#)

Japan

As a member of the G7, Japan has adopted many of the same sanctions measures as its allies:³³⁶

Finance and trade

- Restrictions on key financial institutions, including the Russian Central Bank, and a prohibition on Russian sovereign debt in Japanese financial markets.
- Prohibitions on trade with the LPR and DPR. Russian-backed officials in the LPR and DPR are also subject to a travel ban and asset freeze.
- Export bans on any goods that facilitate the strengthening of Russian industry, semiconductors, computers and any goods destined for military organisations in Russia; military goods; dual-use goods; oil refining equipment; alcohol and tobacco products, perfumes, leather goods and furs; clothing and jewellery; antiques, works of art; gold and banknotes; wood products; luxury cars; electrical machinery and vehicles and any products related to chemical weapons.
- An import ban on gold and non-industrial diamonds of Russian origin.

³³² Canada has not, however, imported any crude oil from Russia since 2019. Natural Resources Canada, [News release](#), 28 February 2022

³³³ [G7 statement of Finance Ministers](#), 2 September 2022

³³⁴ Transport Canada, [News release](#), 27 February 2022

³³⁵ Government of Canada, [Sanctions – Russian invasion of Ukraine](#) (accessed 21 January 2025)

³³⁶ Compiled with the help of Ashurst, [Sanctions tracker Japan](#) and Baker McKenzie, [Sanctions and export controls blog](#) (both accessed 21 January 2025)

- Revoked Russia's Most Favoured Nation trading status
- Implemented the price cap on imports of Russian crude oil and oil products, although has not established an outright ban.
- Imposed a ban on the provision of trust, accounting, auditing, management consultancy, construction, and engineering services, unless a license is obtained from the Japanese government.
- Sanctions against several defence-related companies and other state-owned entities.
- On 28 March 2022 the Japanese government confirmed that it would revise its foreign exchange laws to prevent Russia from evading sanctions using cryptocurrencies.³³⁷
- In January 2025, sanctions against companies in third countries suspected of facilitating sanctions evasion (including UAE, China, Turkey, India and some Central Asian states), were imposed for the first time.³³⁸

Individual designations

- Sanctions on Russian leadership and government officials, including President Putin, Sergey Lavrov and Sergei Shoigu.
- Sanctions on military officials, including the Russian Chief of the General Staff Valery Gerasimov.
- Sanctions against several Russian oligarchs and family members, including several executives linked to the Wagner group.
- Sanctions against individuals and organisations who have played a direct role in destabilising eastern and southern Ukraine and the incorporation of the occupied regions by Russia.

Japan has also imposed sanctions on Belarus for its role in the Russian invasion of Ukraine, including on President Alexandr Lukashenko.³³⁹

Japan has not closed its airspace to Russian commercial aircraft, although the Government has said it will "continue to examine the situation and "take appropriate measures".³⁴⁰

10 Useful links

- Ministry of Economy, Trade and Industry, [Sanctions against Russia](#) (in Japanese)
- Government of Japan, [Japan stands with Ukraine](#) (PDF), October 2023

³³⁷ Reuters, "[Japan to revise foreign exchange law](#)", 28 March 2022

³³⁸ Baker McKenzie, [Sanctions and export controls blog](#) (accessed 21 January 2025)

³³⁹ Baker McKenzie, [Sanctions and export controls blog](#) (accessed 8 March 2022)

³⁴⁰ Kyodo News, "[Japan to freeze assets of 4 more Russian banks to align with EU](#)", 3 March 2022

Other allies and partners

Australia

At the time of writing, Australia has imposed sanctions on more than 1,200 individuals and entities supporting the invasion of Ukraine.

Australian Government, [Russia's invasion of Ukraine](#)

Australian sanctions were first imposed against Russia in 2014 and extended again in 2015. Among those restrictions was a ban on the export of arms and related materiel to Russia and the export of goods and services used in oil exploration and production.³⁴¹

In response to Russia's invasion of Ukraine, the Australian government has announced a raft of additional measures, in support of Western-led sanctions. Announcing the first round of new sanctions on 23 February 2022, the then Foreign Minister, Marise Payne, said "In taking these actions, we are in alignment with our key partners, the United States and the United Kingdom" and that this was "the beginning of our sanctions process".³⁴²

Since February 2022, Australia has:

- Expanded the criteria for sanctions designation to include individuals and entities "of strategic and economic significance to Russia".³⁴³
- Extended the prohibitions already in place on [trade with Crimea and Sevastopol](#) to the LPR and DPR.³⁴⁴
- Imposed asset freezes on Russian financial institutions, including the Russian Central Bank and the Russian Ministry of Finance. The majority of Russia's banking sector and government entities responsible for issuing and managing Russia's sovereign debt are now covered by Australia's sanctions regime.³⁴⁵
- Sanctioned President Putin along with members of Russia's National Security Council and other government ministers and senior officials. In February 2022, Foreign Minister Payne said "It is exceedingly rare to designate a head of state and reflects the depth of our concerns".³⁴⁶
- Sanctioned family members of the Russian leadership.³⁴⁷
- Sanctioned political officials, individuals and organisations that have supported Russia's invasion or have facilitated Russia's actions in Ukraine, including the Wagner group.³⁴⁸ Australia has also listed the Russian Imperial Movement, which it has identified as an ultra-nationalist group known for its anti-Semitic, anti-LGBTQI and anti-

³⁴¹ Parliament of Australia Library, [FlagPost: Sanctions on Russia](#), 28 February 2022

³⁴² Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 23 February 2022

³⁴³ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 23 February 2022

³⁴⁴ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 23 February 2022

³⁴⁵ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 23 February 2022 and [Media release](#), 18 March 2022; [Media release](#), 19 May 2023

³⁴⁶ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 28 February 2022; [Media release](#), 24 February 2023 and Prime Minister of Australia, [Press release](#), 4 July 2022; [Media release](#), 20 July 2023

³⁴⁷ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 22 April 2022 and Prime Minister of Australia, [Press release](#), 4 July 2022

³⁴⁸ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 22 April 2022; [Press release](#), 4 May 2022; [Press release](#), 18 May 2022; [Media release](#), 22 October 2022 and Australian Government, [Federal Register of Legislation](#), 23 February 2023

Ukrainian views and which has reportedly sent foreign fighters to join Russian separatists in Ukraine.³⁴⁹

- Imposed sanctions on military officials responsible for the conduct of the campaign in Ukraine, including those alleged to be involved in the conduct of war crimes.³⁵⁰
- Imposed sanctions on individuals and organisations promoting disinformation, including state-owned media platforms, pro-Kremlin news outlets, Dmitry Peskov, President Putin's Press Secretary and Maria Zakharova, Spokesperson for the Russian Foreign Ministry.³⁵¹
- Imposed sanctions on those involved in the deportation of Ukrainian children from regions under Russian occupation.³⁵²
- Imposed import bans on Russian oil, refined petroleum products, natural gas, coal and other energy products,³⁵³ and Russian-origin gold.³⁵⁴
- Imposed export bans on luxury goods,³⁵⁵ aluminium ores, including bauxite and related products³⁵⁶ and all machinery and related parts.³⁵⁷
- Sanctioned companies across strategic Russian sectors, including defence, aerospace, energy and minerals.³⁵⁸
- Designated Russian oligarchs, prominent Russian businesspeople and their family members.³⁵⁹
- Prohibited the extension of any loans, or other financial assistance, that supports trade with, or investment in, Russia and Belarus.³⁶⁰

In line with G7 countries, Australia announced on 31 March 2022 that it would withdraw Most Favoured Nation (MFN) status from Russia and Belarus. Effective as of 25 April 2022, an additional 35% tariff is applied to all imports from Russia and Belarus.³⁶¹ That measure was recently extended until October 2025.³⁶²

Australia has also joined allies in sanctioning Belarus and Russia's procurement networks involved in the production and transfer of Iranian

³⁴⁹ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 18 May 2022

³⁵⁰ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 8 March 2022 and [Press release](#), 7 April 2022; [Media release](#), 19 May 2023

³⁵¹ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 8 March 2022; [Press release](#), 25 March 2022

³⁵² Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 24 February 2024

³⁵³ Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade, [Press release](#), 11 March 2022

³⁵⁴ Prime Minister of Australia, [Press release](#), 4 July 2022

³⁵⁵ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 5 April 2022

³⁵⁶ Australian Government, [Autonomous sanctions \(Export sanctioned goods – Russia\) Designation 2022](#)

³⁵⁷ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 19 May 2023 and Federal Register of Legislation, [Autonomous sanctions \(Export sanctioned goods – Russia\) Amendment \(No 1\) Designation 2023](#), 25 October 2023

³⁵⁸ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 14 April 2022 and [Media release](#), 24 February 2023; [Media release](#), 19 May 2023; [Media release](#), 20 July 2023 and [Media release](#), 24 February 2024

³⁵⁹ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 14 March 2022; [Media release](#), 18 March 2022 and Prime Minister of Australia, [Press release](#), 4 July 2022

³⁶⁰ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 20 October 2022

³⁶¹ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 31 March 2022

³⁶² Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Press release](#), 25 September 2023

unmanned aerial vehicles (UAV) to Russia for use in Ukraine,³⁶³ and the transfer of arms and munitions from North Korea.³⁶⁴

11 Useful links

- Australian Government, [Snapshot: Russia/Ukraine sanctions regime](#) (PDF)
- Australian Government, [Invasion of Ukraine by Russia](#)
- Australian Government, [Russia sanctions regime](#)
- Australian Government, [Sanctions: Consolidated list](#)

New Zealand

On 7 March 2022 then New Zealand Prime Minister, Jacinda Ardern, announced that the Government would introduce legislation to allow it to bring “first of its kind” autonomous sanctions against Russia. Previously New Zealand could only implement sanctions imposed by the UN Security Council. The Prime Minister said the limitations of the current multilateral system, specifically Russia’s UN Security Council veto, necessitated the introduction of legislation.³⁶⁵

[Under that legislation](#) the [first sanctions were approved on 17 March 2022](#). To date, New Zealand has:³⁶⁶

- Banned Russian-linked aircraft and vessels from entering New Zealand airspace and territorial waters.³⁶⁷
- Sanctioned over 500 Russian officials, military figures, oligarchs and proxies, including: President Putin, permanent members of the Russian Security Council, members of the State Duma and Federation Council, those engaging in disinformation and propaganda and individuals supporting Russia’s occupation of Ukraine, the forced relocation of Ukrainian children and the theft of Ukrainian cultural property.
- Sanctioned Russia’s defence industrial complex and key state-owned enterprises that are providing revenue to Russia.
- Sanctioned key banks and financial institutions.
- Imposed export bans on goods connected to strategic Russian industries, luxury goods and goods for oil exploration and production.
- Revoked Russia’s MFN status, thereby applying a 35% tariff on all products of Russian origin. Import tariffs have been extended until 2025.
- Banned the import of Russian energy products, Russian gold and luxury goods.

³⁶³ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 10 December 2022 and [Media release](#), 20 March 2023

³⁶⁴ Australian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, [Media release](#), 24 February 2024

³⁶⁵ New Zealand Government, [Press release](#), 7 March 2022

³⁶⁶ New Zealand Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade, [Russian sanctions](#) and [Latest updates](#) (accessed 27 September 2024)

³⁶⁷ New Zealand Government, [Press release](#), 7 March 2022

- Sanctioned those involved in the occupation of the Zaporizhzhia Nuclear Power Plant.

In line with the US, UK, Australia and the EU, sanctions are also applied to Belarus and New Zealand has also designated a number of Iranian individuals and companies involved in the production and supply of weapons to Russia.³⁶⁸

12 Useful links

- New Zealand Foreign Affairs and Trade, [Russian sanctions](#)
- New Zealand Government, [Russia sanctions register](#)

3.4

A halt to Nord Stream 2

Nord Stream 2 (NS2) is a natural gas pipeline that directly connects Russia to Germany, via the Baltic Sea. It was launched in 2015 by Nord Stream 2 AG, a subsidiary of the Russian state-controlled company Gazprom.

The direct supply of gas to Europe via Nord Stream 2 would allow Russia to largely bypass Ukraine, which was a major transit country of Russian gas pipelines into Europe. Transit fees were thought to account for almost 3% of Ukraine's GDP, [bringing an expected revenue of \\$2-3 billion annually over the next five years](#). The Ukrainian Government described NS2 as akin to an ["economic and energy blockade"](#).³⁶⁹

Opposition to the pipeline had been fierce with [critics viewing it as a political project of the Kremlin](#) and part of a broader geopolitical strategy to undermine the West. This is because it increases European reliance on Russian gas supplies and potentially gives Russia leverage over security of supply. Russia said NS2 was "strictly a commercial project".³⁷⁰

Among the economic and financial sanctions initially being discussed by Western allies was the potential halt of the Nord Stream 2 project.

Several senior figures in the then new German coalition government, including Chancellor Scholz and then German Defence Minister, Christine Lambrecht, had previously argued that it should not be linked to Russian-

³⁶⁸ New Zealand Ministry of Foreign Affairs and Trade, [Latest updates](#), 14 December 2022, 5 May 2023, 17 May 2024, 12 July 2024 and 28 November 2024

³⁶⁹ Radio Free Europe, ["Merkel: New pipeline impossible without clarity for Ukraine"](#), 10 April 2018

³⁷⁰ [President of Russia](#), 15 February 2022

Ukrainian tensions.³⁷¹ Under pressure from allies, however, the German Government appeared to shift position and at the end of January 2022 said that, in the event of Russian military action in Ukraine “nothing would be off the table, including Nord Stream 2”.³⁷²

Considered an “ultimate sanction”, few expected Nord Stream 2 to be among initial sanctions measures announced. However, on 22 February 2022, Chancellor Scholz announced that the certification process for Nord Stream 2 would be halted “for the time being” and that “the geopolitical situation makes a reassessment of Nord Stream 2 imperative”.³⁷³ The German Government subsequently withdrew the previous Government’s [security of supply analysis](#), which is a prerequisite for certification of the pipeline. The US Government also terminated its waiver on NS2 sanctions and reimposed them with immediate effect.

An attack on the Nord Stream 1 and Nord Stream 2 gas pipelines in September 2022 subsequently left the project untenable.³⁷⁴

In December 2024, the US re-designated companies and individuals associated with the construction of the Nord Stream 2 pipeline under Executive Order 14024, which authorises sanctions with respect to harmful foreign activities of the Russian Government.³⁷⁵ US Sanctions had previously been imposed under the [Protecting Europe’s Energy Security Act](#).

³⁷¹ See The Financial Times, “Germany’s Russia problem: Ukraine crisis tests new Government”, 31 January 2022 and Politico, [“Russian test for Scholz: Ukraine crisis exposes divisions in Berlin”](#), 17 January 2022

³⁷² Twitter, [German Ambassador to the United States](#), 26 January 2022

³⁷³ Federal Ministry for Economic Affairs and Climate Action, [Press release](#), 22 February 2022

³⁷⁴ [“Russia criticises German progress in Nord Stream sabotage inquiry”](#), The Guardian, 19 August 2024

³⁷⁵ US Department of State, [Fact Sheet](#), 18 December 2024

4

Are sanctions making a difference? Suggested reading

“Trade continues flowing, it just flows in a different way”.

Hamad Buamim, Chair of the Dubai Multi Commodities Centre, May 2024

With the conflict in Ukraine almost in its fourth year, questions remain over the efficacy of sanctions as Russia has sought alternative markets, trade routes and methods for circumventing Western-led sanctions. The International Monetary Fund forecast that Russia’s economy would grow faster than most of the world’s advanced economies in 2024.³⁷⁶

Government/ EU material

US Department of the Treasury, [Oil Price Cap Analysis](#), February 2024

Council of the European Union, [Impact of sanctions on the Russian economy](#), October 2023 (not updated)

Parliamentary material

Treasury select committee, [Oral evidence: Work of the Office of Financial Sanctions Implementation](#) (PDF), HC418, 26 November 2024. Follow on letters were also provided to the committee by [the OFSI](#) on 19 December 2024 (PDF) and [the National Crime Agency](#) (PDF) on 10 January 2025.

Treasury select committee inquiry (discontinued in May 2024 due to the general election), [Are the UK’s Russian financial sanctions working?](#) In light of the election, the committee published [a letter to the Treasury](#) (PDF) on 24 May setting out the observations and developing views of the committee.

Foreign Affairs Committee Inquiry (discontinued in May 2024 due to the general election), [The situation in Ukraine and the UK’s response](#)

House of Lords European Affairs Committee, [The Ukraine effect: The impact of Russia’s invasion of Ukraine on the UK-EU relationship](#) (PDF), HL48, Session 2023-2024. This report was [debated in the House of Lords](#) on 21 November 2024.

³⁷⁶ International Monetary Fund, [Russian Federation](#) (accessed 4 July 2024) and [“Russia to grow faster than all advanced economies, says IMF”](#), BBC News, 16 April 2024

Treasury Select Committee, [Defeating Putin: the development, implementation and impact of economic sanctions on Russia](#), HC1186, 23 March 2022

NATO Parliamentary Assembly, [The state of Russia's wartime economy](#), 6 May 2024

Academic and think tank research

Stanford University, [The International Working Group on Russian Sanctions](#)

Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air, [Financing Putin's war](#)

Center on Global Energy Policy at Columbia, [Q&A: How will new US sanctions affect Russia's energy sector?](#), January 2025

Atlantic Council, [Five questions \(and expert answers\) about Biden's final round of sanctions on Russia](#), January 2025

Chatham House, [Independent Thinking Podcast: Do sanctions work?](#), 1 November 2024

Carnegie Politika Podcast, [Unbalancing act: What the 2025 budget says about the Russian economy](#), October 2024

RUSI, [Punishing Putin: A conversation with Stephanie Baker](#), 1 October 2024

Carnegie Endowment for International Peace, [How the latest sanctions will impact Russia – and the world](#), 20 June 2024

Brookings Institution, [Sanctions on Russia: What's working? What's not?](#), 28 May 2024

RUSI Suspicious Transaction Report Podcasts, [Episode 17: The economic impact of sanctions against Russia: Fact and fiction](#), 24 May 2024

Atlantic Council, [Oil, gas and war: The effect of sanctions on the Russian energy industry](#), 23 May 2024

Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air, [Kremlin pitstop: EU imported EUR3bn of oil products from Turkish ports handling Russian oil](#) (PDF), 15 May 2024

Kyiv School of Economics, [Russian oil revenues rising, tougher sanctions needed on shadow fleet](#), 30 April 2024

Center for Strategic and International Studies, [Back in stock? The state of Russia's defense industry after two years of the war](#), April 2024.

Centre for Research on Energy and Clean Air, [Open letter to G7 and European Union leaders](#) (PDF), 21 February 2024

[“How Russia is burning down the sanctions house – and what to do about it”](#), RUSI Commentary, 6 February 2024

Atlantic Council, [“Russia’s growing dark fleet: Risks for the global maritime order”](#), 11 January 2024

[“Western sanctions on Russia and the Global South’s stance”](#), RUSI Commentary, 23 November 2023

[“Track and disrupt: How to counter sanctions evasion networks”](#), RUSI Commentary, 10 November 2023

Kupatadze and Marat, [Under the radar: How Russia outmanoeuvres Western sanctions with help from its neighbours](#) (PDF), Research Paper No.18 University of Birmingham, August 2023

Tom Keatinge, [“Developing bad habits: What Russia might learn from Iran’s sanctions evasion”](#), RUSI Occasional Paper, 6 June 2023

[“Global south does not buy Western stance on Ukraine”](#), Barcelona Centre for International Affairs, May 2023

[Catch-235: Western dependence on Russian nuclear supplies is hard to shake](#), RUSI Commentary, 12 April 2023

[Silicone lifeline: Western electronics at the heart of Russia’s war machine](#) (PDF), RUSI, August 2022

Media

[“Russia sanctions: fears over UK enforcement by HMRC”](#), Sky News, 17 January 2025

[“No convictions for breaching sanctions on Russia”](#), BBC News, 17 January 2025

[“Russia’s plunging currency spells trouble for its war effort”](#), The Economist, 1 December 2024

[“The war in Ukraine is straining Russia’s economy and society”](#), The Economist, 28 November 2024

[“Never mind the war, the French Riviera still loves oligarchs”](#), Politico, 15 September 2024

[“The mysterious middlemen helping Russia’s war machine”](#), The Economist, 19 August 2024

[“Vladimir Putin spends big – and sends Russia’s economy soaring”](#). The Economist, 11 August 2024

[“Putin ‘peddling lies’ about ailing Russian economy, says EU ministers”](#), The Guardian, 24 July 2024

[“Opinion: Western companies are still fuelling Putin’s war machine”](#). The Financial Times,

[“The critical cog in Putin’s machine and how British firms help to keep Russian gas flowing into Europe”](#). Sky News, 2 July 2024

Agathe Demarais, [“Opinion: Export controls on Russia might be working better than you think”](#). Politico, 24 June 2024

[“Sanctions hole: How secretive routes supply Russia with western tech and consumer goods”](#). The Guardian, 12 June 2024

[“Russia’s economy is growing, but can it last?”](#). BBC News, 6 June 2024

[“Russian sanctions are ineffective says Dubai trade hub chief”](#). The Financial Times, 29 May 2024

[“UK sanctions watchdog flops in face of Russia’s war”](#). Politico, 20 May 2024

[“Russian oil still seeping into the UK – the reasons why sanctions are not working”](#). Sky News, 8 May 2024

[“Western banks in Russia paid €800mn in taxes to Kremlin last year”](#). The Financial Times, 29 April 2024

[“The Baltic border loophole in EU’s Russia sanctions”](#). Politico, 14 February 2024

[“Sanctions aren’t working: How the West enables Russia’s war on Ukraine”](#). Politico, 11 December 2023

[“Western sanctions didn’t stop the war: Were they worth it?”](#). Politico, 20 February 2023

[“Dozens of Russian weapons tycoons have faced no Western sanctions”](#). Reuters, 1 July 2022

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